

EvenUCan

from idea to object

User Manual · version 1.9.37

Draw your own things and print them. Or pick the parts for an electronics project, and EvenUCan designs a printable box to hold them, shows you how to wire them up, and writes the code to run them.

It all runs on your own computer. Only the optional AI features use the internet.

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Important: a free AI key is needed to start a new project

"Tell it your idea" — the wizard step that turns a plain-English description into a parts list, a box and code — needs an AI to do that one translation. It is the only part of the whole program that has to reach the internet.

Bring your own free key

Five AI gateways work with EvenUCan: Google Gemini, Groq and OpenRouter (all free, no card needed), NVIDIA (free, desktop app only), or your own paid Anthropic Claude key. Set one up from the wizard's first screen, or any time from the "AI key" button on the toolbar.

Kept on your own device only

Your key is saved in the app's own local settings (or this browser's storage for the web version) and is never sent anywhere except the AI company you chose.

Everything after that is offline

Once the AI has turned your idea into a parts list, the 3D box designer, the wiring diagram and the ESPHome / Arduino / Raspberry Pi code all run entirely on your own computer — no AI, no internet, needed again for that project.

Don't want to use AI at all?

Click "Carry on without AI" instead of describing your idea: start from one of six ready-made examples, or tick the parts you have, and the rest of the app works exactly the same way.

If a project you are building from a description fails with a message such as "The AI couldn't be reached" or "Couldn't reach OpenRouter", this page is why: check that an AI key is set up and valid, or switch to a different free AI from the dropdown next to "Make it with AI".

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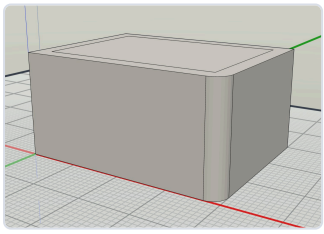
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1 Welcome: what can EvenUCan do for me?

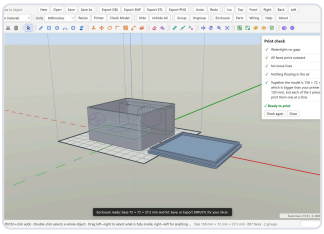
EvenUCan takes you from an idea to a finished, working gadget. Use as much or as little of it as you like: each step leads naturally into the next.

1. **Draw your own things.** Sketch a flat shape, pull it up into 3D, round off the edges, cut holes, sweep, slice. If you've used SketchUp you'll feel at home, and if you haven't, you'll be making real parts in minutes.
2. **Save it and print it.** One click checks it's really ready to print (no gaps, nothing floating in mid-air, small enough for your printer) and saves a file your slicer opens straight away.
3. **Starting an electronics project?** Choose your parts from over 2,000 ready-made boards, sensors, screens and modules. You don't need to know the part number: search for what it does, like *temperature*, *gyroscope* or *screen*, and add it to your box with one click.
4. **One click, one custom box.** The Enclosure Wizard arranges your parts and builds a printable case to hold them: holes lined up with the sockets, buttons and sensors, posts that print without supports, and a lid that fits.
5. **Not sure how to wire it up?** Click **Wiring**. A diagram and a tick-list show exactly which pin goes to which, with safe pins chosen for you and a warning wherever something needs care.
6. **We'll even write the code.** EvenUCan writes the program for your board. Install the free **ESPHome Device Builder** on your computer, click **Open in ESPHome**, and your device appears there: plug the board in and click Install, and ESPHome builds the program and puts it on the board. Tell it what the gadget should do in your own words, and AI fills in the rest.

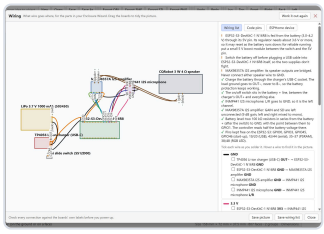
Projects made simple: your idea, a little thought, and some help from AI.



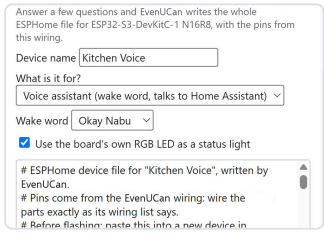
1 · Draw it



2 · Build the box



3 · Wire it up



4 · Make the code

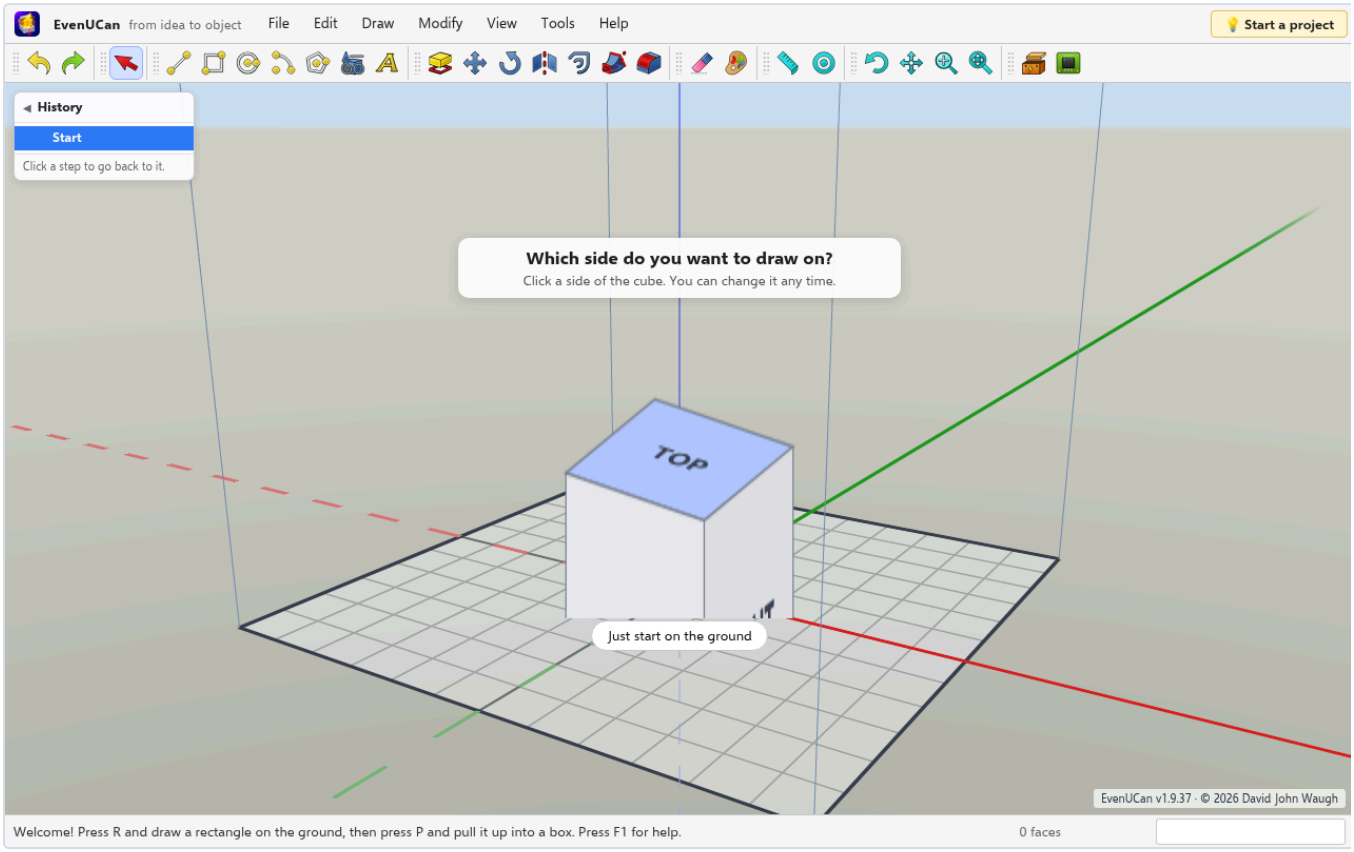
This manual follows the same path: drawing and printing first (chapters 5 to 7), then parts, the box, wiring and the code (chapters 8 to 12).

New: rather be guided? The **step-by-step wizard** (chapter 2) walks you through all four steps, one question at a time, and checks the free software you need is installed.

★ What's new in 1.9.37

This chapter covers the newest parts of EvenUCan: the menu bar and toolbar, Follow Me, the AI helper, carrying on without AI, and the new easy-to-read wiring diagram.

The menu bar and toolbar



The main window. Menus along the top, the toolbar underneath, and the **Start a project** button on the right.

Menu	What's in it
File	Start a project, New, Open, Save, Save As, export (3MF or STL for 3D printing, OBJ, a picture), printer size, check model for printing.
Edit	Undo, redo, cut, copy, paste, delete, select all/none, hide and unhide, delete guides.
Draw	Every drawing tool: line, rectangle, circle, arc, polygon, 3D text, Push/Pull, Move, Rotate, Offset, Follow Me, rounding, eraser, paint, tape measure.
Modify	Slice, shell, holes, join/subtract/intersect, group, flip and mirror, exact resize, lay flat, arrange on the bed.
View	Standard views, zoom to fit, orbit/pan/zoom, perspective or parallel, and units.
Tools	Start a project, the Parts library, the Box designer, Wiring, Code for your board, and the **AI helper key**.
Help	The quick guide and shortcuts (F1), this manual, EvenUCan on GitHub, About.

The toolbar buttons are the same tools in picture form, grouped as: undo/redo · select · drawing · shaping (Push/Pull, Move, Rotate, Mirror, Follow Me) · eraser and paint · measuring · camera · box and electronics. Hover over any button to see its name and shortcut key.

Follow Me

1. Draw the shape you want to sweep (for example a small circle or a rounded profile) standing up at the start of an edge.
2. Pick **Draw** → **Follow Me** (or its toolbar button) and click the shape.
3. Click the path: an edge or the top face of your box. The path lights up orange.
4. EvenUCan sweeps the shape along the whole path, which is handy for rounded rims, lips and grooves.

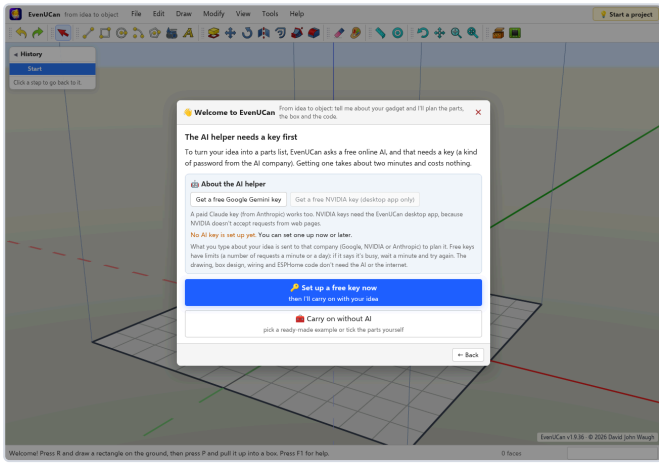
> Press Esc to cancel, or Ctrl + Z to undo a sweep you don't like.

The AI helper (and when it uses the internet)

The drawing, box design, wiring and ESPHome code all work offline. Only the AI helper needs the internet: the wizard's **I have an idea for a gadget**, **Write the code with AI**, **Make it with AI**, and **Fill in automatically** in the Parts Library. It needs a key: a free one from Google Gemini, a free one from NVIDIA (desktop app only), or your own paid Claude key.



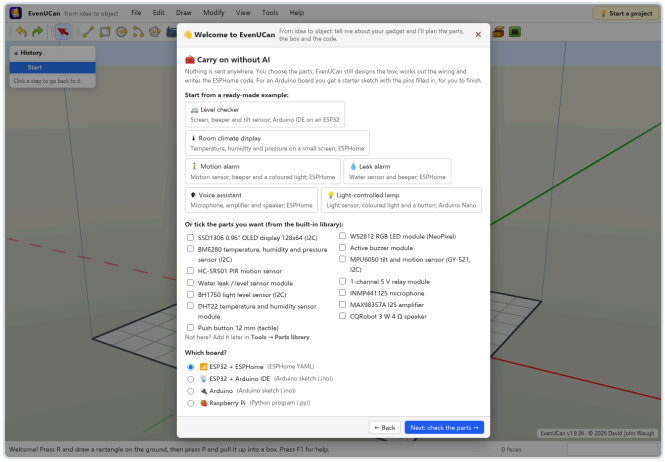
The welcome box explains the AI helper up front.



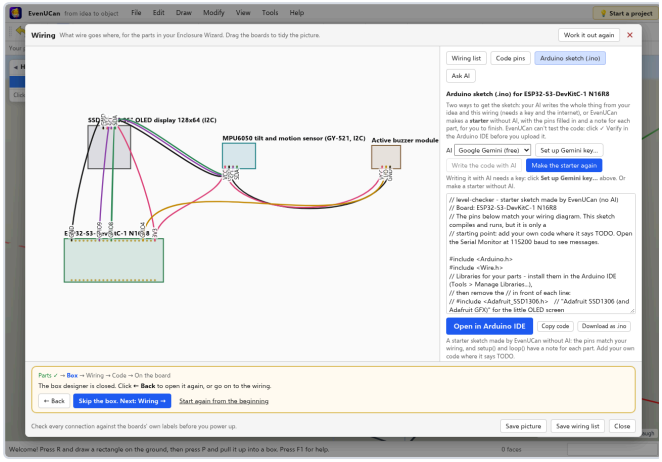
No key? You get a choice, not a dead end: get a free key, or carry on without AI.

Carrying on without AI

Click **Carry on without AI**. You can start from an example project, or tick the parts you already have from the list. EvenUCan then designs the box, draws the wiring and writes the ESPHome code just as before, with no internet needed.

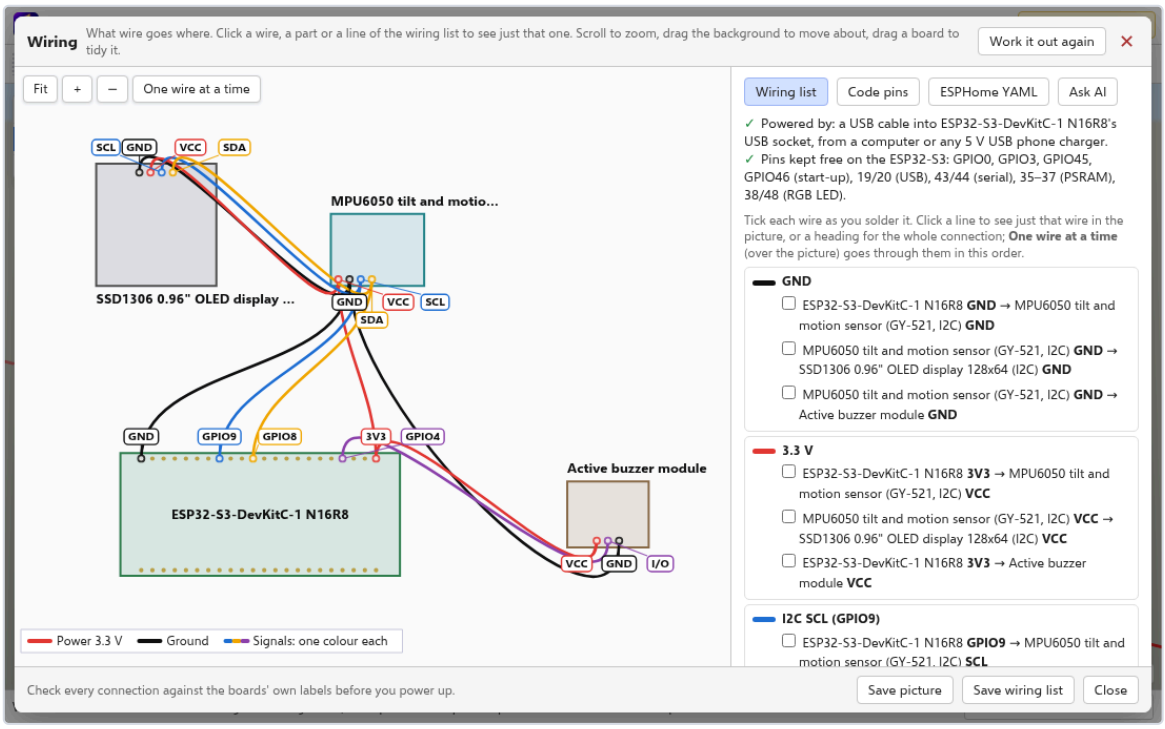


Pick an example or tick your parts.



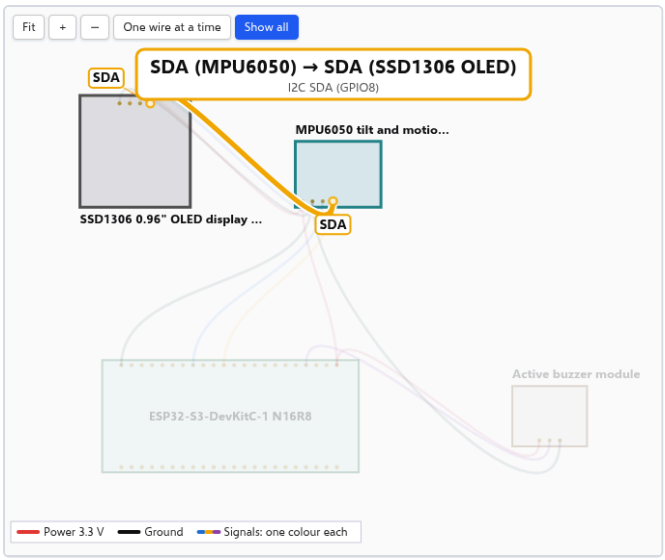
Without AI you still get a starter Arduino sketch that sets up every pin, ready to open in the Arduino IDE.

The new wiring diagram

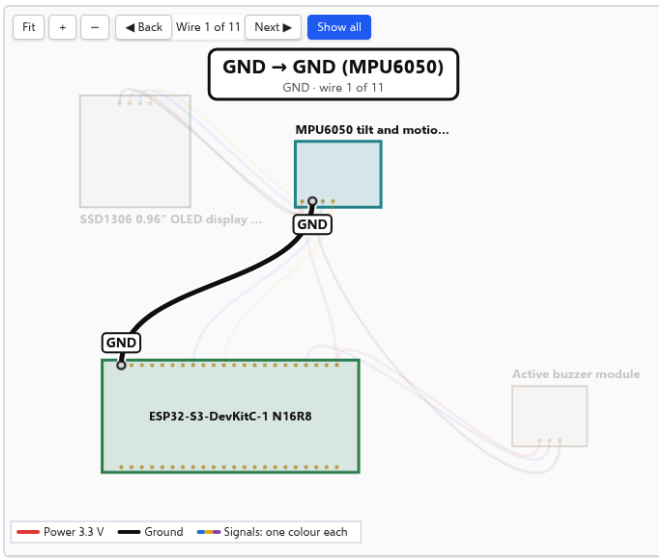


The controller sits in the middle with the parts spread around it. Only the pins you use are labelled, outside the boards, with thin leader lines so the labels never overlap.

- **Wire colours:** red for power, black for ground, and a different colour for each signal. A small key explains them.
- **Focus:** click a row in the wiring list, a wire, or a part. Everything else fades and one big label says exactly what to connect, for example *GPIO8 → SDA (SSD1306 OLED)*. Click `Show all` (or the empty background) to see everything again.
- **One wire at a time:** click `One wire at a time`, then `Next` and `Back`, in the same order as the list. Tick each wire off as you go. The arrow keys work too.
- **Zoom and move:** use the mouse wheel (or pinch) to zoom, drag the background to move around, and click `Fit` to see the whole diagram. You can still drag the boards about.
- **Save picture** saves a sharp picture of the whole diagram, whatever you're zoomed into.



Focus on one connection.



One wire at a time: step 1.

2 Getting started

Which file to use

Everything is on the EvenUCan download page on GitHub: **github.com/bullbrand/EvenUCan/releases**. Pick the one for your computer. Each one is the whole program.

File	What it does
EvenUCan-Setup-1.9.33.exe	Windows: installs the program with a Start menu and desktop shortcut. Uninstall it from Settings › Apps.
EvenUCan-Portable-1.9.33.exe	Windows: just double-click it. Nothing is installed, so it also runs from a USB stick.
EvenUCan-1.9.33.dmg	Mac: open it and drag EvenUCan into Applications.
EvenUCan-1.9.33.AppImage **EvenUCan-1.9.33.deb**	Linux: the AppImage runs on its own (make it executable first); the .deb installs on Ubuntu, Debian, Mint and the like.
EvenUCan_1.9.33_Web.zip	The web-page version: unzip it and double-click **EvenUCan.html**. It runs in Chrome or Edge, nothing installed. Keep the files from the zip together in one folder.

Windows needs Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit). Installing a newer version over an older one keeps your drawings, parts and settings.

"Windows protected your PC" (and the Mac warning)

The first time you run it, Windows may show a blue box, because the program isn't signed by a big company. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. On a Mac, right-click EvenUCan, choose **Open**, then **Open** again. You only need to do this once.

Checking the file is genuine

The download page has a file called SHA256-checksums.txt that lists a long code for every download, like a fingerprint (the web zip also has its own SHA256 checksums - Web version.txt inside). If even one byte of a file is changed (by a virus or a broken download), the code comes out different.

1. Open the folder that holds the download, click in the address bar at the top, type `powershell` and press Enter.
2. Type `Get-FileHash "EvenUCan-Portable-1.9.33.exe"` (use the name of your file) and press Enter.
3. The code it shows must match the one in the checksums file. If it doesn't, don't run the file.

> **Tip:** on a Mac or Linux, open Terminal and type `shasum -a 256` followed by the file name instead.

First thing to do: tell it your printer

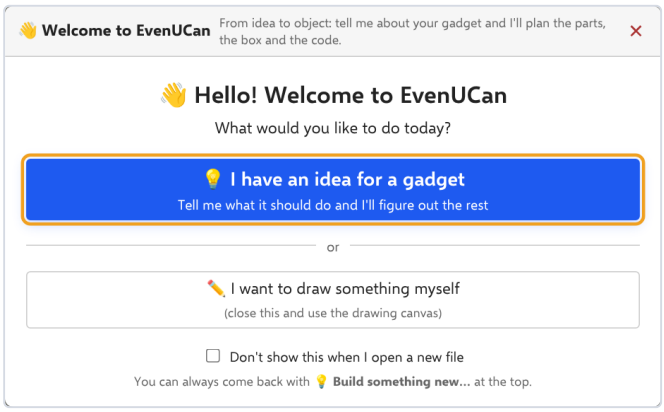
Click Printer on the top bar and pick your printer, or type its build size (X, Y and height Z, in mm). The grid then shows your bed, and the app warns you if anything is too big to print.

The step-by-step wizard NEW

EvenUCan now walks you through a whole project in the right order, so you never end up writing code for parts you haven't got, or wiring parts that don't exist yet:

💡 Idea → 📦 Parts → 🏠 Box → 🔌 Wiring → 💻 Code → ✅ Done

When you open EvenUCan with a fresh, empty drawing, the Welcome window greets you. Choose 💡 **I have an idea for a gadget** to be guided, or ✏️ **I want to draw something myself** to go straight to the drawing canvas.



The Welcome window. It opens any time from 💡 **Build something new...** at the top.

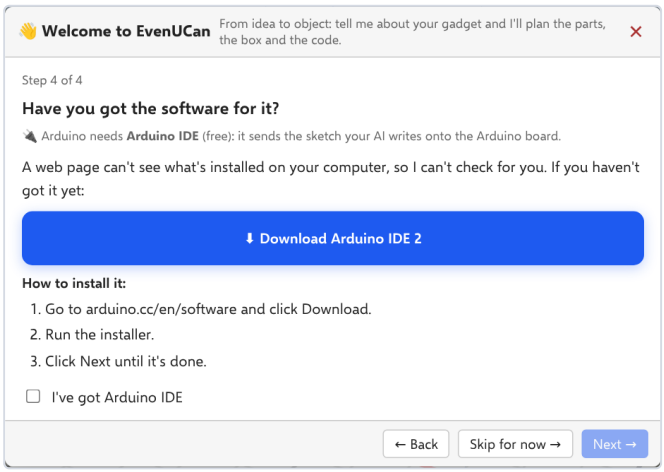
Experienced? Skip it

Tick **Don't show this when I open a new file** and EvenUCan starts on the drawing canvas instead. Every window (Enclosure, Parts, Wiring) still works on its own, in any order. If you open Wiring or the code before choosing any parts, a short message reminds you to **add some parts first**, but it never stops you.

Telling it your idea

1. **Step 1:** describe your gadget in your own words, for example "an alarm for my shed that tells my phone when someone goes in". The example buttons fill one in for you.
2. **Step 2** (optional): tick what it should show or do when it's working.
3. **Step 3:** choose the equipment you've got: ESP32, Arduino, Raspberry Pi, or **not sure** (EvenUCan suggests what to buy).

Step 4: have you got the software for it?



Step 4 for an Arduino, in the web-page version.

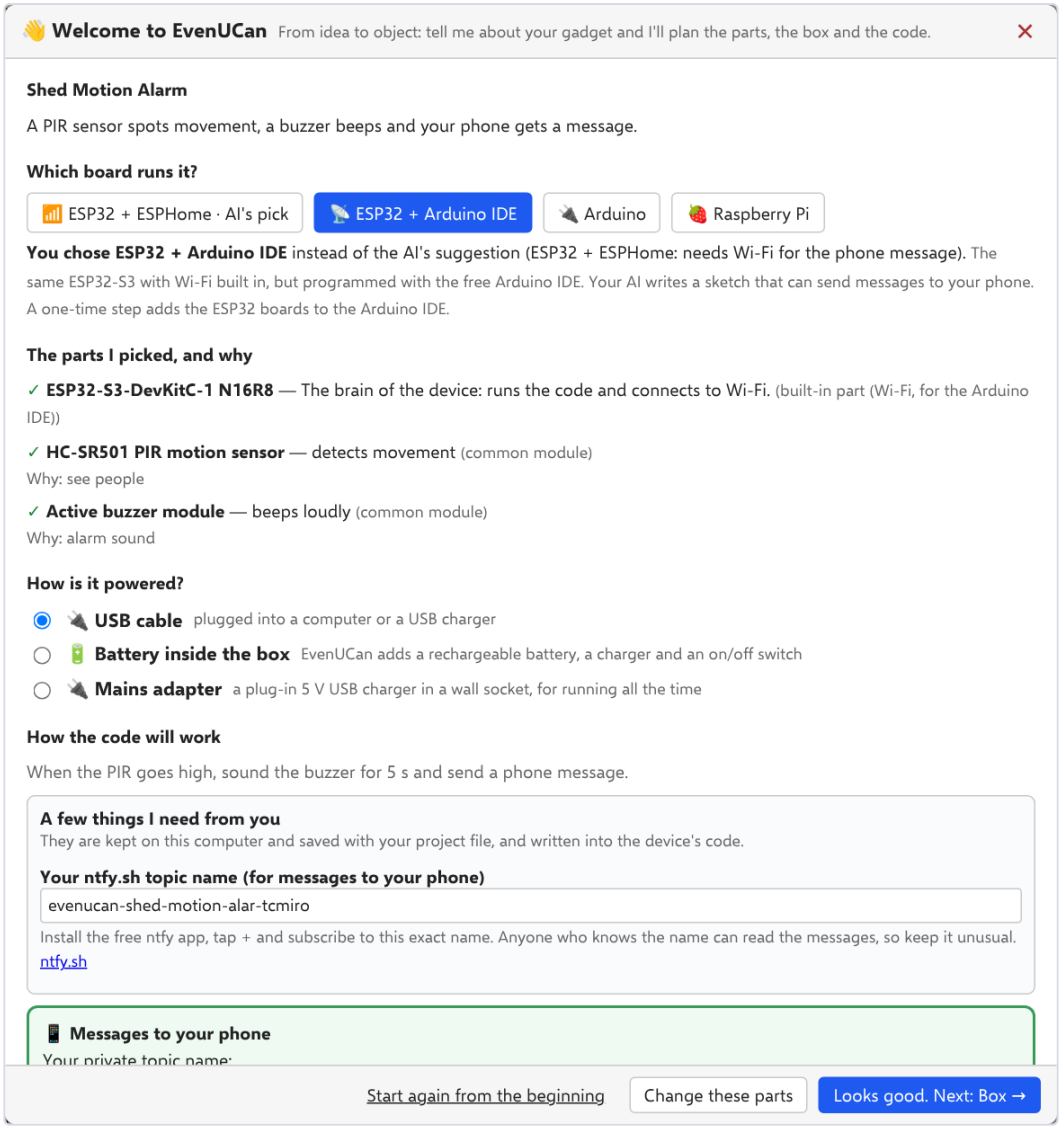
Each kind of board needs one free program on your computer to put the code on it:

Board	Program
ESP32 (ESPHome)	ESPHome Device Builder: esphome.io/install
Arduino	Arduino IDE 2: arduino.cc/en/software
Raspberry Pi	Thonny: thonny.org

The **desktop program** checks for you, and goes straight on if it's already installed. A **web page** can't see what's on your computer (it only spots ESPHome if it's running), so it shows a download button and three simple install steps; tick **I've got …** when it's done. **Skip for now** always works. If you chose **not sure**, this step is left out until you've picked a board.

Your plan

Your AI turns the idea into a plan: which board runs it, the parts it picked and why, how it's powered, and how the code will work. You can pick a different board with the buttons at the top, and EvenUCan explains what changes. If the gadget sends messages to your phone, it also makes you a private **ntfy** topic name (see below). Click **Looks good. Next: Box →**.



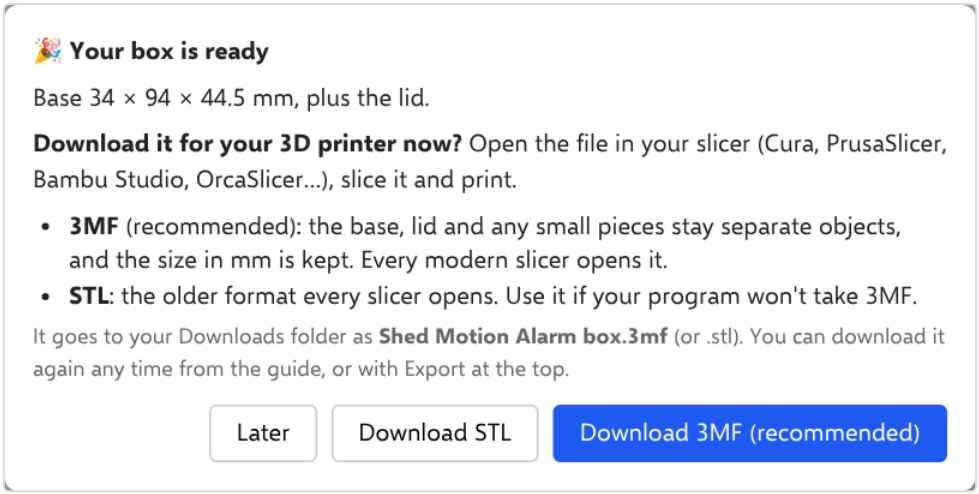
The plan for "Shed Motion Alarm", with ESP32 + Arduino IDE chosen instead of the AI's own suggestion.

Your progress and the guide

Once you've got a plan, a **Your progress** strip appears above the 3D view, with a tick beside every step that's done. Click any step to jump to it. A yellow **guide box** always tells you what to do next, with one clear **Next** button, **← Back**, and **Start again from the beginning** if you want a fresh start (what you've made stays until you change it).

Your box is ready: download it for your printer NEW

When you click `Generate base + lid` in the Enclosure Wizard, EvenUCan asks straight away whether you want the file for your 3D printer:



The download offer, as soon as the box is made.

- **Download 3MF (recommended)**: the base, the lid and any small extra pieces stay as separate objects in your slicer, and the size in mm is kept.
- **Download STL**: the older format every slicer opens. Use it if your slicer won't take 3MF.
- **Later**: no problem. The guide box keeps **⬇ Download the box (3MF)** and **⬇ STL** buttons, so does the final "project is ready" screen, and **Export 3MF** / **Export STL** at the top always work.

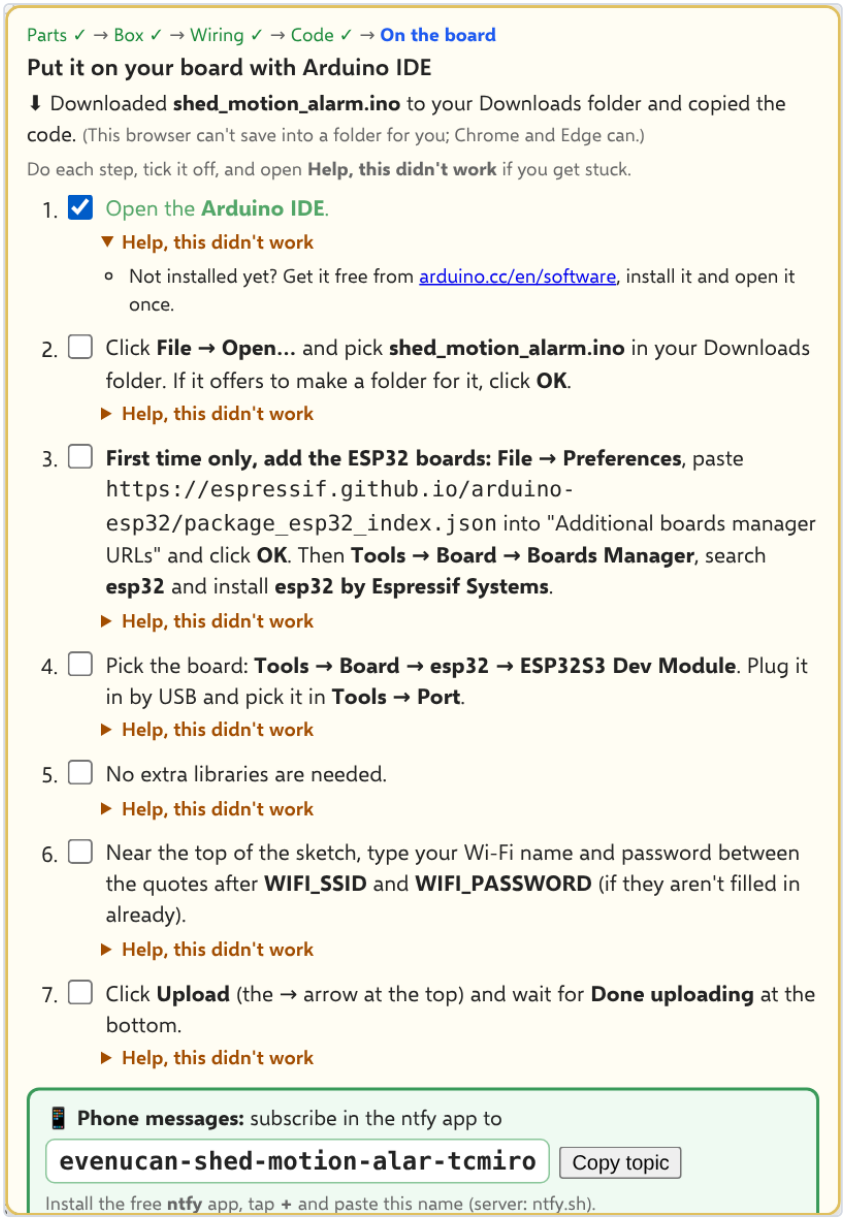
The file goes to your Downloads folder, named after your project (for example Shed Motion Alarm box.3mf). Open it in Cura, PrusaSlicer, Bambu Studio, OrcaSlicer or any other slicer, slice it and print.

Putting the code on your board NEW

After the wiring, EvenUCan writes the code. The big blue button is named for your program: **Open in ESPHome**, **Open in Arduino IDE** or **Open in Thonny**. Here's what it does:

Version	What happens
Desktop program	Sends the code straight into the program and opens it: ESPHome Device Builder gets the new device, the Arduino IDE opens the sketch, Thonny opens the Python file.
Web page in Chrome or Edge	The first time, it asks you to pick the folder once (your ESPHome config folder, your Arduino **sketchbook**, usually Documents › Arduino, or a folder for your Pi files). After that the code is saved straight into it, every time.
Other browsers	The file goes to your Downloads folder and the code is copied, ready to paste.

Then a **step-by-step guide** opens beside your work and stays there until you've finished. Do each step and tick it off. If something goes wrong, open **Help, this didn't work** under that step for the usual fixes. When the code is running, click ✅ **It's on my board!**.



The guide for an ESP32 programmed with the Arduino IDE. Step 1 is ticked, and its help is open.

> **Wi-Fi:** your Wi-Fi name and password are never put in the code by EvenUCan. For ESPHome they come from ESPHome's **Secrets**; for Arduino the guide shows where to type them (between the quotes after `WIFI_SSID` and `WIFI_PASSWORD`).

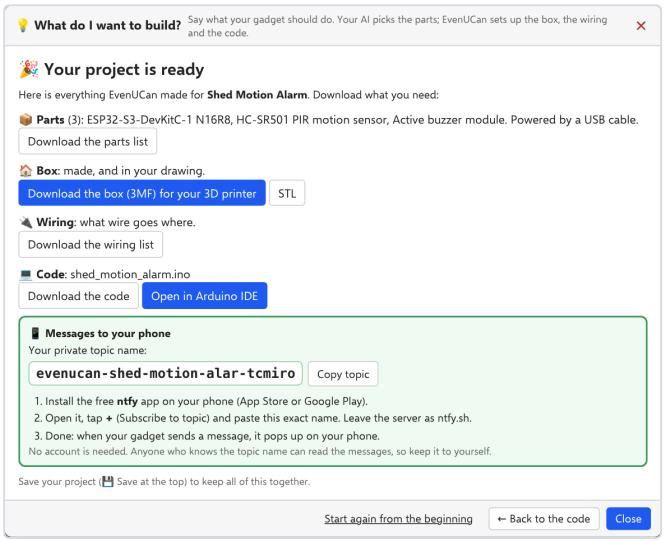
Messages to your phone

If your gadget sends alerts, it uses the free **ntfy** service. No account is needed:

1. Install the free **ntfy** app on your phone (App Store or Google Play).
2. Open it, tap **+** (Subscribe to topic) and paste your private topic name, shown in the plan, the guide and the final screen (**Copy topic** copies it). Leave the server as ntfy.sh.
3. That's it: when your gadget sends a message, it pops up on your phone.

Anyone who knows the topic name can read the messages, so keep it to yourself.

🎉 Your project is ready



The last screen: everything EvenUCan made, ready to download.

The last screen lists everything for your gadget, each with its own download button: the **parts list** (to buy from), the **box** (3MF or STL), the **wiring list**, and the **code**, with the **Open in ...** button again. Your phone topic is there too.

Click Save at the top to keep the whole project together in one .3mf file.

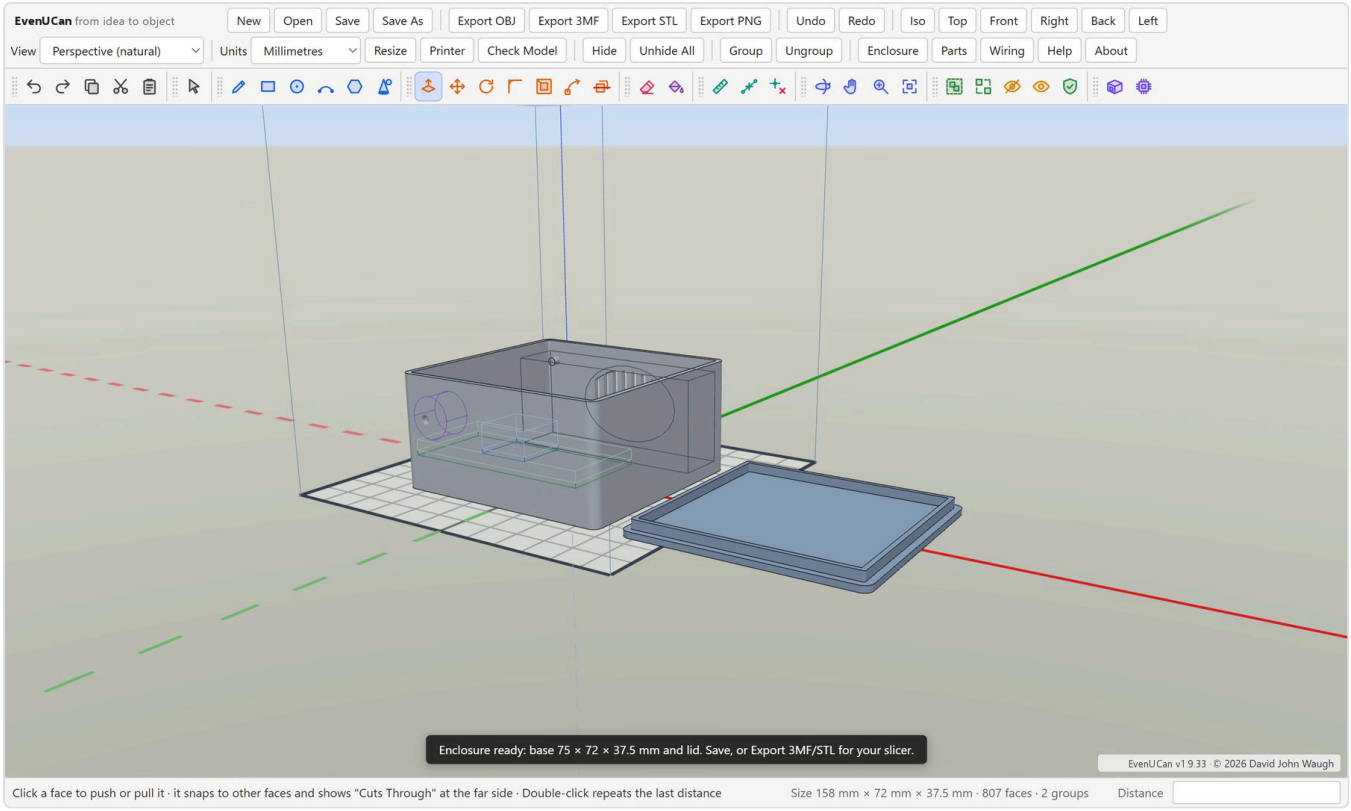
If something in the new steps goes wrong

Problem	What to do
I closed the wizard	Click 💡 **Build something new...** at the top, or any step in the **Your progress** strip.
"Add some parts first"	Wiring and code need parts. Pick them in the Enclosure Wizard or the Parts Library, or describe your idea with **Build something new...**.
I missed the box download	Use ⬇ **Download the box (3MF)** in the guide box, the final screen, or **Export 3MF** at the top.
Open in ... didn't open my program	The web page can't start programs itself, so open the program yourself and follow the guide's steps. Not installed? The first step's **Help, this didn't work** has the download link.
It saved into the wrong folder	Use **Choose a different folder** in the guide (desktop app, Chrome or Edge), or just use **Download again**.
It asks for parts-library.json again	The web version asks once per browser. Choose the parts-library.json that came in the zip.
No messages on my phone	Check the topic in the ntfy app matches exactly (use **Copy topic**), and that the gadget is on your Wi-Fi.

Saved with your file

The Enclosure Wizard's part list and the Wiring/ESPHome answers are kept inside the file itself (not just on this computer), so opening it somewhere else (another PC, a reinstall, switching between the web page and the desktop program) brings your electronics setup back too, not just the box shape. Autosave also says so plainly if the browser's storage fills up and it can't keep up, instead of quietly falling behind.

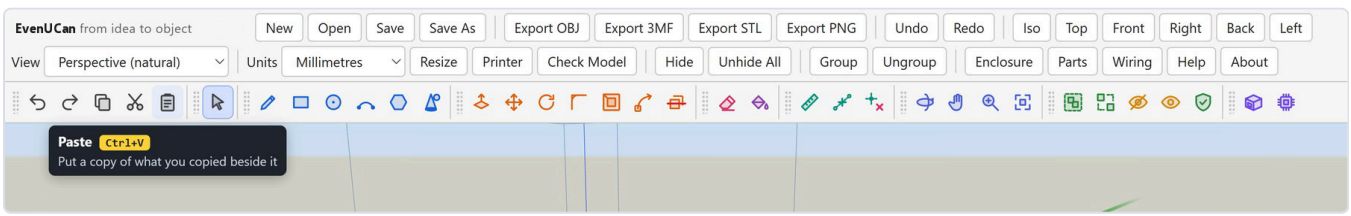
3 The screen



The main window, here showing an enclosure made by the Enclosure Wizard: the base, and the lid turned over beside it, ready to print. The thin coloured outlines inside are the electronic parts.

Area	What it's for
Top bar	Files (New, Open, Save, Export), Undo/Redo, the view buttons (Iso, Top, Front…), Units, Resize, Printer, Check Model, Hide, Group, and the Enclosure, Parts, Wiring and Help windows. **About** shows which version you have.
Toolbar	The drawing tools, 3D Text, Shell, Hole, Flip and Lay flat (see chapter 5), then the view tools, Group/Ungroup, Join, Subtract, Intersect, Hide/Unhide, Check Model, Enclosure and Parts. The icons are coloured by kind (below).
3D view	Your model on the printer bed. Red, green and blue lines are the X, Y and Z axes. The **view cube** in the top right corner turns with the view (see chapter 4). The **History** panel on the left lists every change, so you can go back several steps at once (see chapter 5).
Status bar	Left: a hint for the tool you're using. Right: the model's size, and the **size box** where numbers you type appear.

The toolbar



Hover over any button to see its name, its shortcut key (in yellow) and what it does.

The icon colours tell you what kind of tool it is: **blue** draws (Line, Rectangle, Circle, Arc); **orange** changes shapes (Push/Pull, Move, Rotate, Round, Offset, Follow Me); **red** erases and **purple** paints; **teal** measures; **indigo** moves the view; **green** groups and checks; **amber** hides; **violet** opens the Enclosure Wizard and Parts Library.

Arranging the toolbar your way

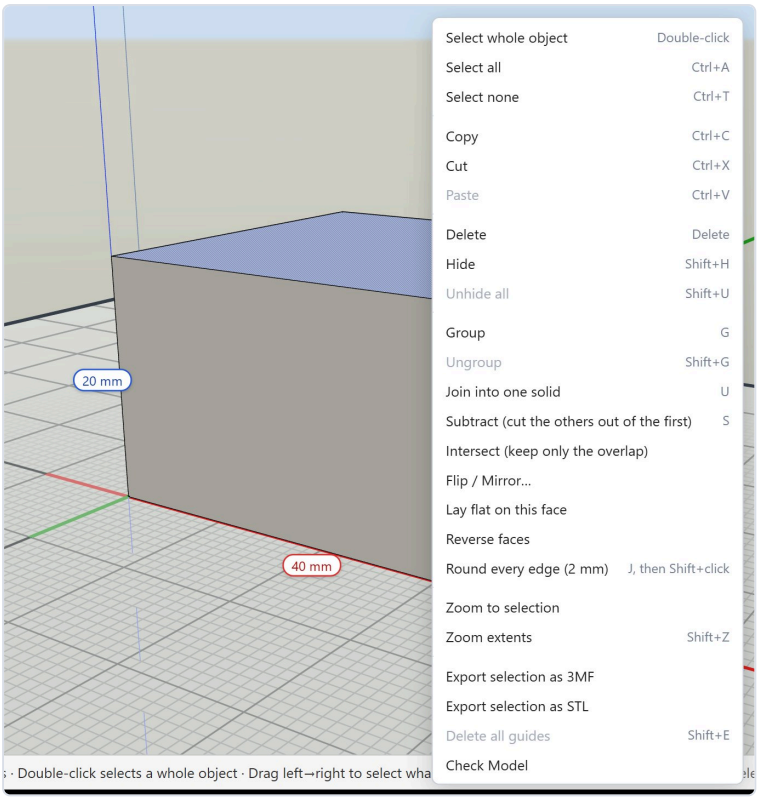
Drag any toolbar button to a new place: the others slide aside and it snaps in. To move a whole group (for example all the blue drawing tools to the front), drag the dotted **grip** at the start of the group. Your order is remembered next time. To go back to the original order, right-click the toolbar.

Press `F1` or click **Help** at any time for a quick guide to every tool.

4 Moving around

Mouse	What it does
Left button	Always belongs to the tool you've picked: it draws, pushes, moves… Click-click or press-drag-release both work.
Right button + drag	Orbit (turn the view) around whatever is under the mouse.
Right click	Opens the right-click menu (see below).
Middle button + drag	Pan (slide the view). Press the scroll wheel down and drag.
Scroll wheel	Zoom in and out, towards where the mouse points.

- `Shift` + `Z` (or the zoom-extents icon) fits everything in view.
- **Right-click** (without dragging) on the model opens a menu (picture below) of common jobs: select the whole object, all or none, Delete, Hide, Group, Join, Subtract, Intersect, Flip / Mirror, Lay flat on this face, Lay all flat on the bed, Arrange on bed, Reverse faces, Round every edge, Zoom to selection, export just the selection, Delete all guides, Check Model. Right-click on something not selected selects it first.
- The **Iso** **Top** **Front** **Right** **Back** **Left** buttons jump to standard views.
- **View** switches between *Perspective* (natural, far things smaller) and *Parallel* (no perspective, good for checking sizes by eye).



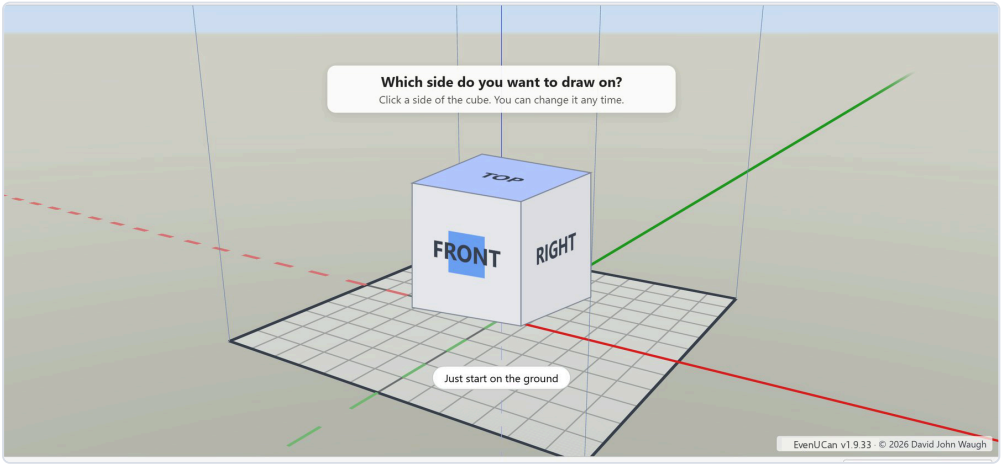
The right-click menu. Greyed-out items don't apply to what's selected.

The view cube: choosing the side you draw on

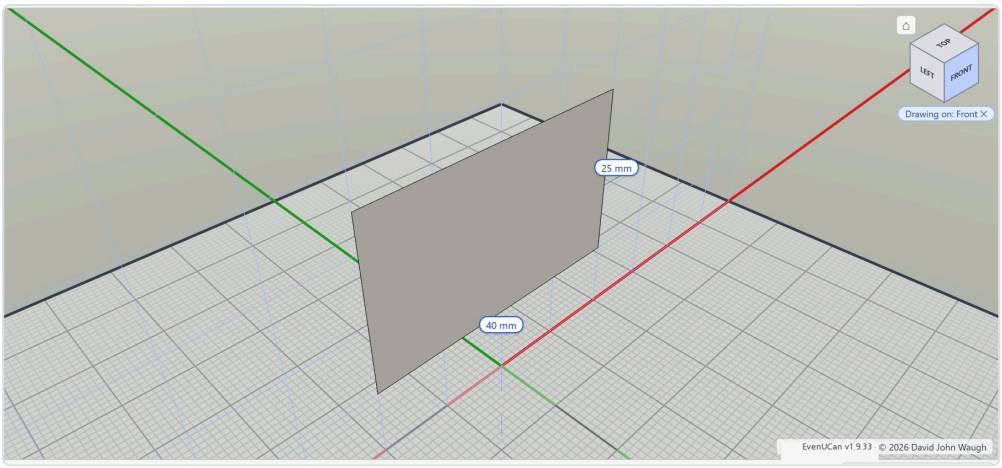
The cube in the top right corner always turns with your view, so you can see which way you're looking.

- **Click a face** of the cube (FRONT, RIGHT, TOP…) to look straight at that side. New shapes are then drawn on that side: a light blue grid shows it, and **Drawing on: Front** appears under the cube. Click that label to go back to drawing on the ground. **TOP** means the ground, as usual.
- **Click an edge or a corner** of the cube for an angled view. The side you draw on stays the same.
- **Drag the cube** to turn the view round, and click ⌂ (top left of the cube) to go back to the normal view of everything.
- A shape drawn *on a face* of your model always goes on that face, whichever side is chosen.

When you start a new, empty drawing, the cube waits in the middle of the screen and asks which side you want to draw on. Click a side, or **Just start on the ground**, and it moves out of the way into its corner.



A new drawing: the cube asks which side to draw on (FRONT is highlighted under the mouse).



After clicking FRONT: a 40 × 25 mm rectangle drawn standing up on the front side, seen from a corner of the cube. Its sizes show beside it.

5 Drawing

EvenUCan works like SketchUp: draw a flat shape, then pull it up into 3D.

1. Press `R` and click two corners on the ground to draw a rectangle. To make it an exact size, type `40,30` and press `Enter`.
2. Press `P` (Push/Pull), click the rectangle and move the mouse up. Type `15` and press `Enter` for exactly 15 mm.
3. Draw a circle on the top face (`C`) and push it down through the box to cut a hole: when it reaches the far side it shows **Cuts Through**, so click to cut.

Tool	Key	How to use it
Select	`Space`	Click to select; Shift-click to add. Double-click selects a whole object. Drag left→right to select what's fully inside the box; right→left to select anything the box touches.
Line	`L`	Click points; closing the loop makes a face. A line across a face splits it. Tracing the open edge of a hole fills it.
Rectangle	`R`	Two corners. Type `width,depth` for exact sizes.
Circle	`C`	Centre, then radius. Type a radius, or `36s` to change the number of sides.
Arc	`A`	Click both ends, then move out to set the bulge and click (it snaps to a half circle). An arc drawn across a face cuts it in two.
Polygon	`N`	A hexagon, triangle or any straight-sided shape. Type `6s`, `3s`, `8s`… for the number of sides, then centre and corner.
3D Shapes	`D`	A ball, cone, cylinder or pyramid in one go (see below).
Push/Pull	`P`	Pull a face into 3D or push it in. Double-click repeats the last distance. `Shift`+click several faces first to push them all together (see below).
Move / Copy	`M`	Pick up and drop. Hold `Ctrl` to copy; then type `5x` for five copies in a row.
Rotate	`Q`	Centre, starting angle, end angle - or type a number of degrees and press Enter. With something already selected, just type the angle straight away: it spins round the selection's own centre, no clicks needed. Small orange arrows round the circle show which way it's about to turn (both ways until you start dragging). It snaps hard to 90°/180°/270°/360°, and every 15° in between.
Round / Chamfer	`J`	Click a line where two faces meet to round it off. Type `3` for 3 mm rounded, `3c` for a 3 mm straight chamfer. `Shift`+click a box to round every edge at once.
Offset	`F`	Click a face, then move in or out: a copy of its outline that far inside or outside it.
Follow Me	`W`	Sweep a face along a selected path (see below).
Flip / Mirror		Flip the selection over, or add a mirrored copy beside it (see below).
Lay flat		Click the face that should go down on the bed (see below).

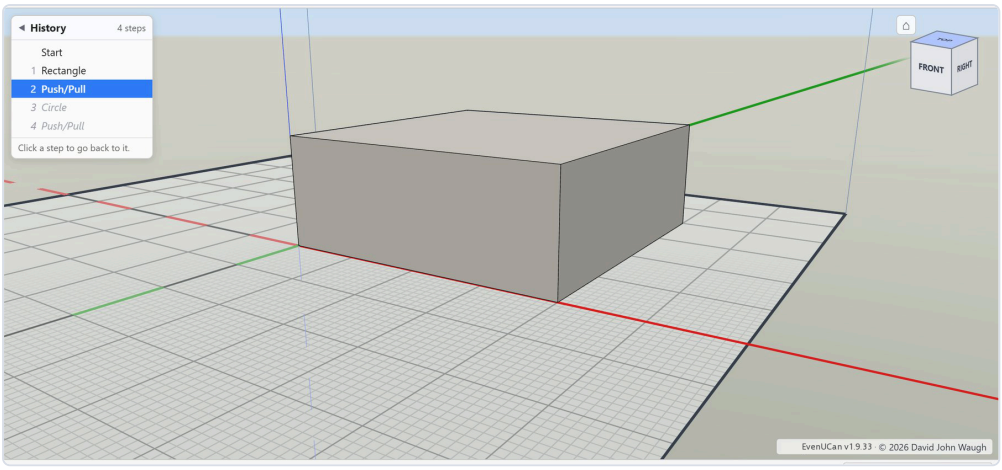
Lay all flat		Does Lay flat for every separate piece in one click, automatically picking each one's own largest face - handy straight after Generate makes several pieces at once.
Arrange on bed		Spreads every separate piece out sideways so none overlap, without changing how high up each one sits.
Shell		Hollow a solid out with walls of a set thickness (see below).
Hole		Screw holes at printing sizes: clearance, tapped, heat-set insert, countersunk, counterbored, nut trap (see below).
3D Text		Raised or engraved lettering (see below).
Slice	`X`	Cut a solid in two with a flat plane; move or delete either half (see below).
Eraser	`E`	Click a single line to remove just that line (faces either side join up).
Paint Bucket	`B`	Colour faces.
Tape Measure	`T`	Measure between two points; an orange guide point is left at the second. After the first click, type a distance (e.g. `40`) for a guide point exactly that far along. `Ctrl`+click just measures.
Find Centre	`K`	Click two points; an orange centre point appears halfway, which every tool can snap to.
Delete guides	`Shift`+`E`	Removes all guide points when you've finished with them (toolbar: dashed cross with a red ×).
Orbit / Pan / Zoom	`O` `H` `Z`	The same as the mouse controls, for people without a middle button.

History: going back several steps

Every change you make is listed in the **History** panel on the left: Rectangle, Push/Pull, Circle, Join and so on, newest at the bottom.

- **Click a step** to go back to the model as it was just after that step, like pressing `Ctrl`+`Z` many times at once. **Start** goes back to the beginning.
- The steps after it turn **grey**. If you went back too far, click a grey step to go forward again.
- As soon as you make a new change, the grey steps are thrown away and the new step takes their place.
- Click the **History** heading to fold the panel away into a small tab, and again to open it.

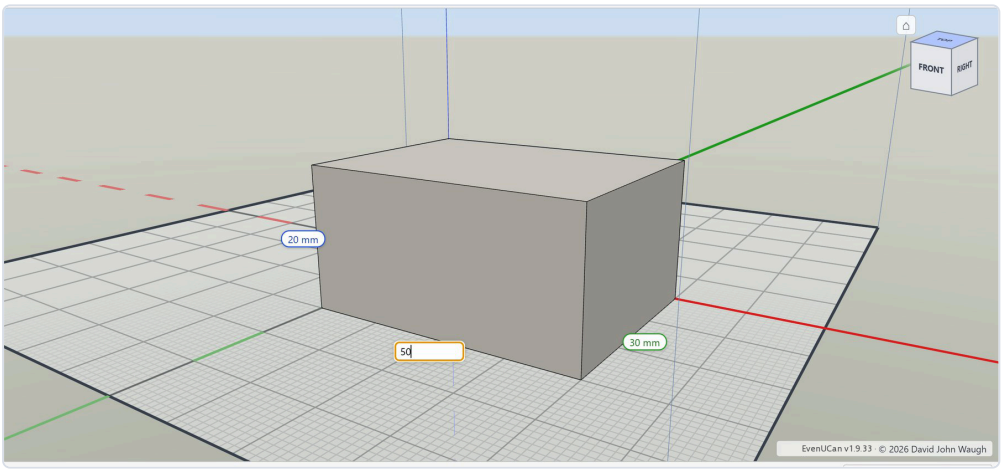
Opening a file or starting a new drawing starts a new history. The last 300 steps are kept.



Four steps: a rectangle pulled into a box, then a circle pushed through it as a hole. Clicking step 2 went back to the plain box; steps 3 and 4 are greyed out and can be clicked to bring the hole back.

Changing a size after drawing

The shape you have just drawn, or the one you select, shows its sizes beside it: a rectangle its two sides, a circle or polygon its diameter (**Ø**), and a box its width, depth and height, coloured red, green and blue like the axes. **Click a size, type the new one and press** `Enter`. For example, if you drew a rectangle 22 mm long, click **22 mm** and type `30`. `Esc` leaves it as it was, and `Ctrl` + `Z` undoes a change.



A 40 × 30 × 20 mm box showing its sizes. The width has been clicked and 50 typed: press Enter and the box is 50 mm wide.

A box keeps its left, front and bottom where they are, and its other side moves. A rectangle keeps one corner where it is. A circle grows or shrinks around its centre.

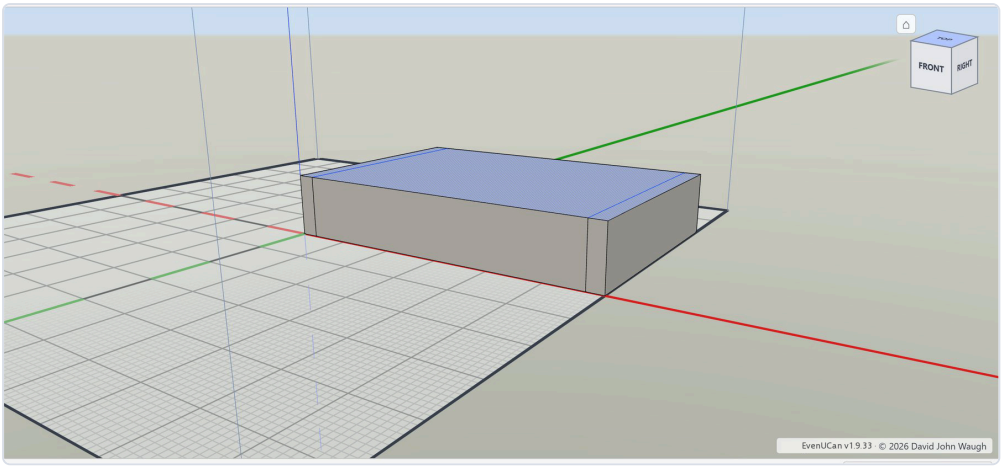
Pushing several faces at once

Say you draw a rectangle on the ground, then two lines 3 mm in from each end, so it is split into three strips. To pull all three up 10 mm in one go:

1. Press `P` (Push/Pull) and `Shift` +click each of the three strips. They turn blue, and the status bar says **3 faces picked**.
2. Click one of them (without Shift), move up, type `10` and press `Enter`.

They all rise together as one solid, with no walls left between the strips, so it is ready to print. Faces you have already selected with the Select tool work the same way. (Only faces facing the same way as the one you

click are pushed with it.)



Three strips picked with Shift+click, being pulled up together.

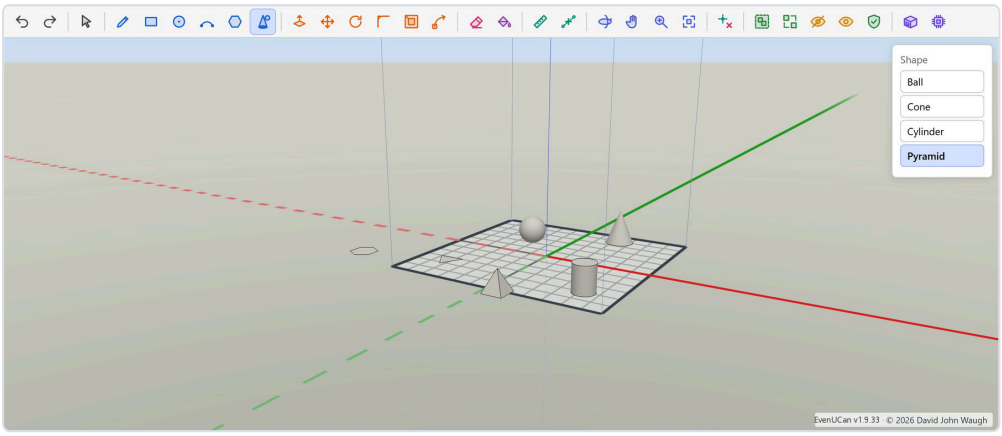
Helpers while you draw

- **Snapping:** the coloured dot shows what you're on: Endpoint (green), Midpoint (cyan), On Edge (red), On Face (blue).
- **Following an axis:** move roughly along red, green or blue and the line snaps to it, so you can draw straight up from the ground, then across in mid-air at that height.
- **Axis lock:** while drawing, the arrow keys lock to an axis: `→` red X, `←` green Y, `↑` blue Z, `↓` unlocks.
- **From Point:** while locked, hover over any corner and the line stops level with it (a dotted line shows which). For example press `↑` and hover the top of another part to draw a post exactly as tall.
- **Guide points:** the Tape Measure and Find Centre leave orange points that every tool snaps to: measure 40 mm from a corner, then draw straight to the point. `Shift` + `E` clears them all.
- **Square helper:** draw two lines meeting in an L and a purple cross shows the missing corner of a perfect square or rectangle.
- **Typing sizes:** just start typing a number; it goes into the size box. Units like `2cm` or `5'6"` work too.

Ready-made shapes

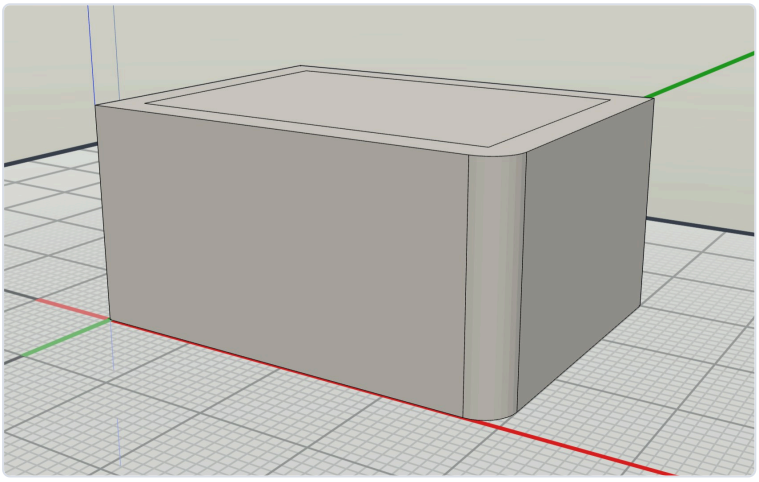
Polygon (`N`) draws flat shapes with straight sides: a hexagon to start with, or type `3s` and `Enter` for a triangle, `8s` for an octagon. Push/Pull a hexagon to make a nut trap or a prism.

3D Shapes (`D`) makes a whole solid at once. Pick **Ball**, **Cone**, **Cylinder** or **Pyramid** in the panel that opens on the right, click the centre on the ground or on a face, then the radius, then the height (a ball needs only its radius). You can type each size and press `Enter` instead. Each shape is its own group, ready to print.



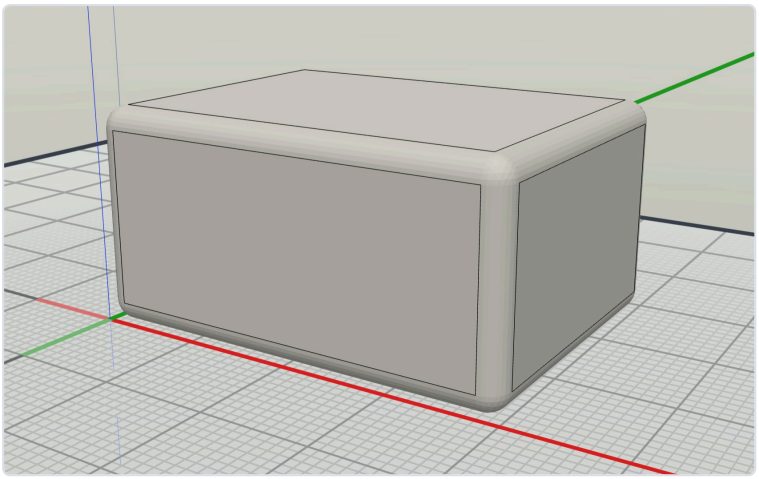
A hexagon and triangle (Polygon), and a ball, cone, cylinder and pyramid (3D Shapes), with the shape panel on the right.

Rounding edges and offsetting



A box with one upright corner rounded (Round, 3 mm), and its top face offset 3 mm inwards, ready to push down into a recess or pull up into a lip.

- **Round / Chamfer** (`J`): hover a line and a blue preview shows the result (red means it can't, with the reason in the status bar). `Ctrl`+click does the other kind once. One line at a time works on any shape, but lines meeting at an already rounded corner can't be done one by one.
- **Round every edge** (`Shift`+click with Round): every edge and corner of a box-like shape is rounded at once, as below. The box keeps its exact size, and prints without sharp edges. It works on shapes without dents, steps or holes; for others, round the lines one at a time.
- **Offset** (`F`): inside, it splits the face into a rim and a middle, so you can Push/Pull the middle (a recess, a lid lip, wall thickness). Type a distance and `Enter`; a minus sign (`-2`) offsets outside. Holes in the face stay with whichever part they end up in.



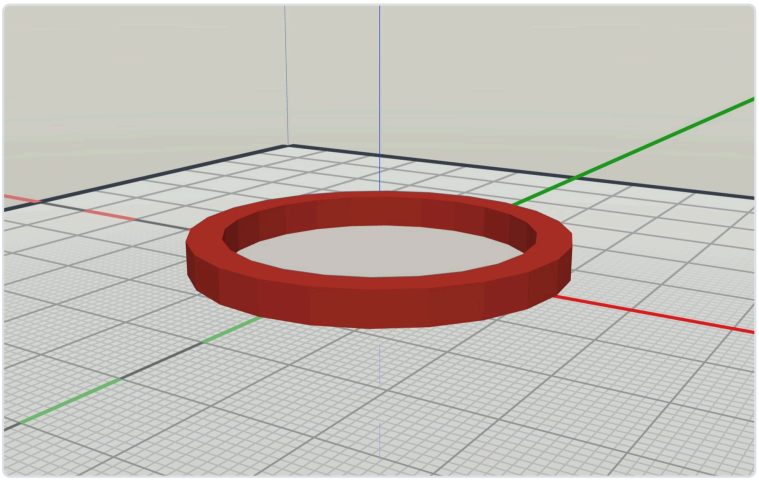
The same 40 × 30 × 20 mm box with every edge and corner rounded (Shift+click, 2 mm).

Follow Me: sweeping a shape along a path

Follow Me pushes a flat shape along a route, like squeezing icing along a line. **Pick the path first, then click the shape.** Example: a ring.

1. **The path:** press `C`, click the ground, type `20` and `Enter`: a flat circle.
2. **The shape, standing across the path:** press `L` and click the circle's edge where it says **Endpoint**. Press `↑`, type `4` `Enter` (up); `→`, move outwards, `3` `Enter`; `↑`, move down, `4` `Enter`; then `↓` and click the first point to close the square.
3. **Select the path:** press `Space` and click inside the circle (it turns blue).
4. **Sweep:** press `W` and click the square. The ring is a new group; select the flat circle and press `Delete` if you don't need it.

A path can be one face (its outline is followed, as here) or lines: select the first and `Shift`+click the rest, as one unbroken chain. The shape must stand across the path (not lie along it), at the start of a line path or anywhere on an outline. A shape with a hole in it makes a tube.



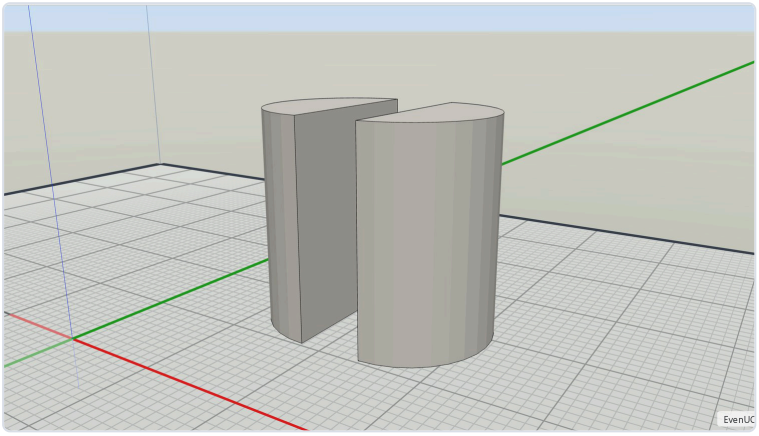
The result: a 3 × 4 mm square swept around a 20 mm circle.

Slice: cutting a solid in two

Something SketchUp doesn't have: **Slice** (`X`) cuts any closed solid in two, for example to print a tall part in two halves, to look inside, or to keep only the top of a box.

1. Press `X` and hover over the shape: a red plane shows where the cut goes, and follows the mouse.
2. Turn the plane with the arrow keys: `↑` flat (a horizontal cut), `→` across the red axis, `←` across the green axis.
3. Click to cut there, or type a distance from the bottom (or left / front) of the shape and press `Enter` for an exact cut.

Each half is closed off with a flat face where it was cut and becomes its own group: move it with `M`, or click it with Select and press `Delete`. Undo (`Ctrl`+`Z`) puts the shape back together.



A cylinder sliced down the middle, with one half moved aside.

Copy and paste

Select something and press `Ctrl`+`C` to copy it (or `Ctrl`+`X` to cut it). `Ctrl`+`V` pastes a copy just to the right of the original, selected and ready to move with `M`; paste again for more copies in a row. After a Cut, the first paste goes back where it was. Copy, Cut and Paste are also on the toolbar (grey, next to Undo) and in the right-click menu.

Groups, joining and hiding

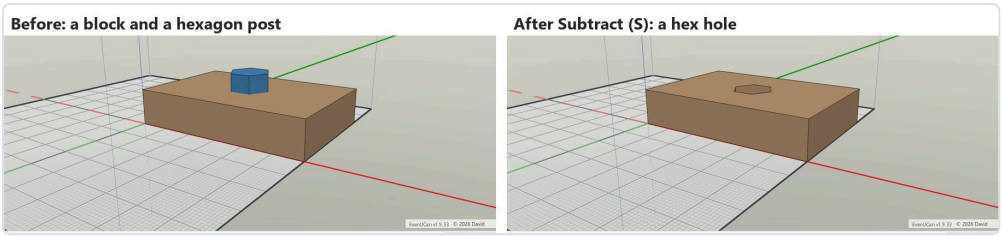
- **Group** (`G`): select items and group them, so they move and rotate as one piece that doesn't stick to other shapes. **Ungroup** with `Shift`+`G`.
- **Join** (`U`): merges two or more objects into **one solid**. Click one, `Shift`+click the others (any face of each will do), then press `U` (or the merged-boxes icon, or the right-click menu). Where they overlap or touch, the walls hidden inside go, so the slicer sees a single piece. Objects that don't touch become one group that moves as one. Each must be a closed solid first (Check Model shows any gaps).
- **Subtract** (`S`) and **Intersect**: see below.
- **Hide** (`Shift`+`H`): hide selected faces to work on what's behind or inside them. **Unhide All** with `Shift`+`U`. Hidden faces are still saved and printed.

Subtract and Intersect: cutting one shape out of another

The quickest way to make a hole, a slot or a nut trap of any shape: stand the shape where the hole should be, then cut it out.

1. Draw the object, and the shape to cut out of it standing through it (for a nut trap, a hexagon pulled up through the part with Polygon, `N`).
2. With Select, click the object to **keep** first, then `Shift`+click the shape to cut out (more than one if you like).

3. Press S (or **Subtract** on the toolbar or the right-click menu).



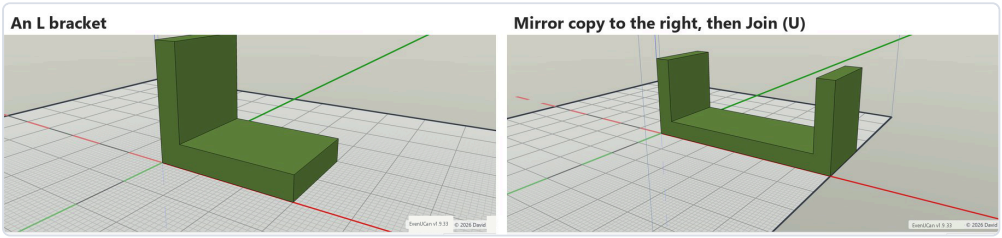
A hexagon post standing through a block, cut out with Subtract: a hex hole, ready for a nut.

Intersect keeps only the part where the selected objects overlap, for example a ball and a box to make a dome. Both need closed solids; if nothing would be left, nothing is changed.

Flip and mirror

Select an object and click **Flip / Mirror** on the toolbar (or in the right-click menu):

- **Flip** left ↔ right, front ↔ back, or **turn upside down**, where it is.
- **Mirror copy** to the right, back or on top: a mirrored copy touching the original. Both are left selected, so press U to join them into one symmetrical part: draw half, mirror the other half.



Half of a bracket, mirrored to the right and joined into one part.

Lay flat: choosing the face it prints on

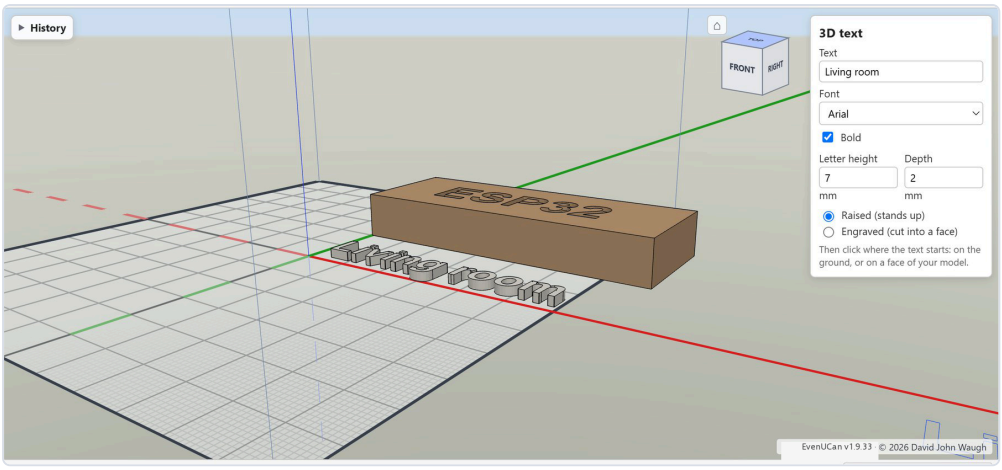
Choose **Lay flat** on the toolbar and click the face that should go down on the printer bed. The object turns over to lie on that face, at bed level. (Also in the right-click menu: **Lay flat on this face**.)

3D text

Put a label on anything, raised or engraved.

1. Click **3D Text** (the T icon). A panel opens on the right: type your text, pick a font (the fonts on your computer), the letter height (of the capital letters) and the depth, and **Raised** or **Engraved**.
2. Move over the model: the outline of the text follows the mouse. Click where the text starts, on the ground or on any face. On a wall it stands upright; on the ground it reads from the front.

Raised text is its own object: to fuse it onto the shape, select both and press U. **Engraved** text is cut into the face you click (it needs a closed solid).



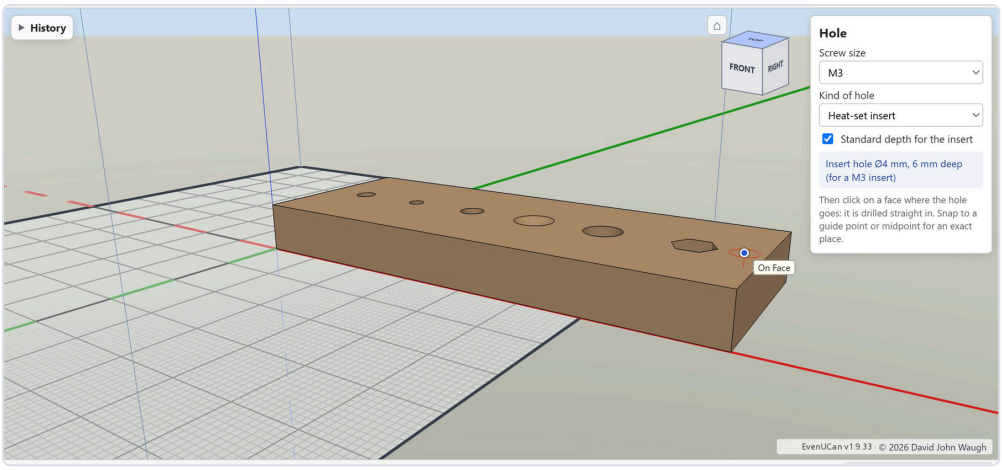
"ESP32" engraved 1 mm into a box, and "Living room" raised 2 mm on the ground, with the text panel.

Holes for screws, inserts and nuts

The **Hole** tool (the target icon) drills screw holes at sizes that work for 3D printing. Printed holes come out a little small, so its clearance holes are a touch bigger than the screw.

1. Click **Hole**. In the panel, pick the **screw size** (M2, M2.5, M3, M4, M5, M6, M8, M10 or M12) and the **kind of hole**. The panel shows the exact sizes it will cut.
2. Leave **Right through** ticked, or untick it and set a depth (or type a depth and press `Enter`; `0` means right through).
3. Move over your model: a red circle shows the hole. Click on a face and it is drilled straight in. Snap to a guide point (Tape Measure) or a midpoint to put it in an exact place.

Kind	What it's for	M3 sizes
Clearance	The screw slides through, into a nut or a part below.	Ø3.4
Threaded	A real metric thread cut into the hole (see below).	M3 × 0.5
Tapped	A smaller pilot hole: the screw cuts its own thread into the plastic.	Ø2.6
Heat-set insert	For brass threaded inserts pressed in with a soldering iron (M2 to M5).	Ø4.0 × 6 deep
Countersunk	Flat-head screws sit flush with the surface.	Ø3.4 with a Ø6.5 cone
Counterbored	Cap-head screws sit below the surface.	Ø3.4 with a Ø6.1 × 3.3 step
Nut trap	A hex pocket holds the nut so it can't turn.	Ø3.4 with a 5.8 mm hex × 2.7 deep

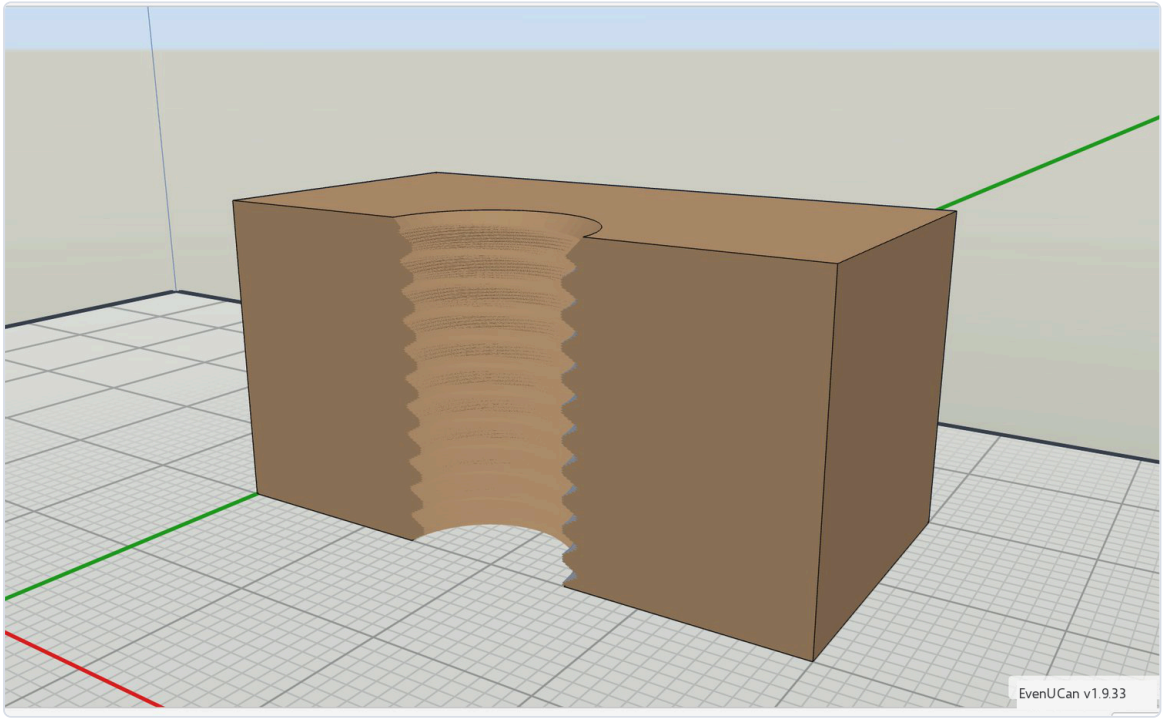


An 8 mm plate with one M3 hole of each kind (left to right: clearance, tapped, insert, countersunk, counterbored, nut trap), and the Hole panel set for a heat-set insert.

Threaded holes

Choose **Threaded** and the hole gets a real metric thread at the standard coarse pitch (M3 × 0.5, M8 × 1.25, M12 × 1.75 and so on), cut right through or to the depth you set. It is cut 0.3 mm roomier than the screw, because printed threads come out a little tight, and a small cone at the mouth helps the screw start.

> **Tip:** threads from **M6** up print well. M2 to M5 threads are very fine (ridges only 0.3 to 0.4 mm high) and wear quickly in plastic: a **heat-set insert** or a **tapped** hole is stronger for those. Print threaded holes standing upright (the hole pointing up) for the cleanest thread.

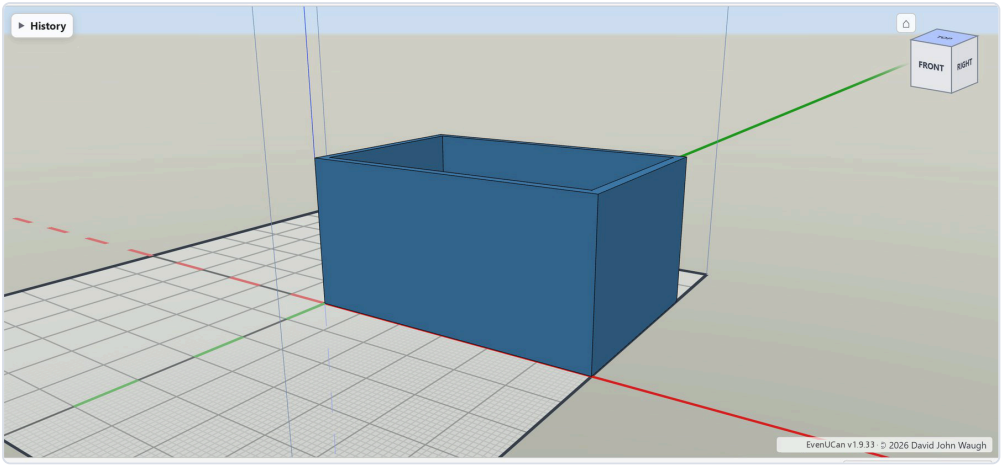


An M12 threaded hole through a 20 mm block, cut in half (with Subtract) to show the thread.

Shell: hollowing out

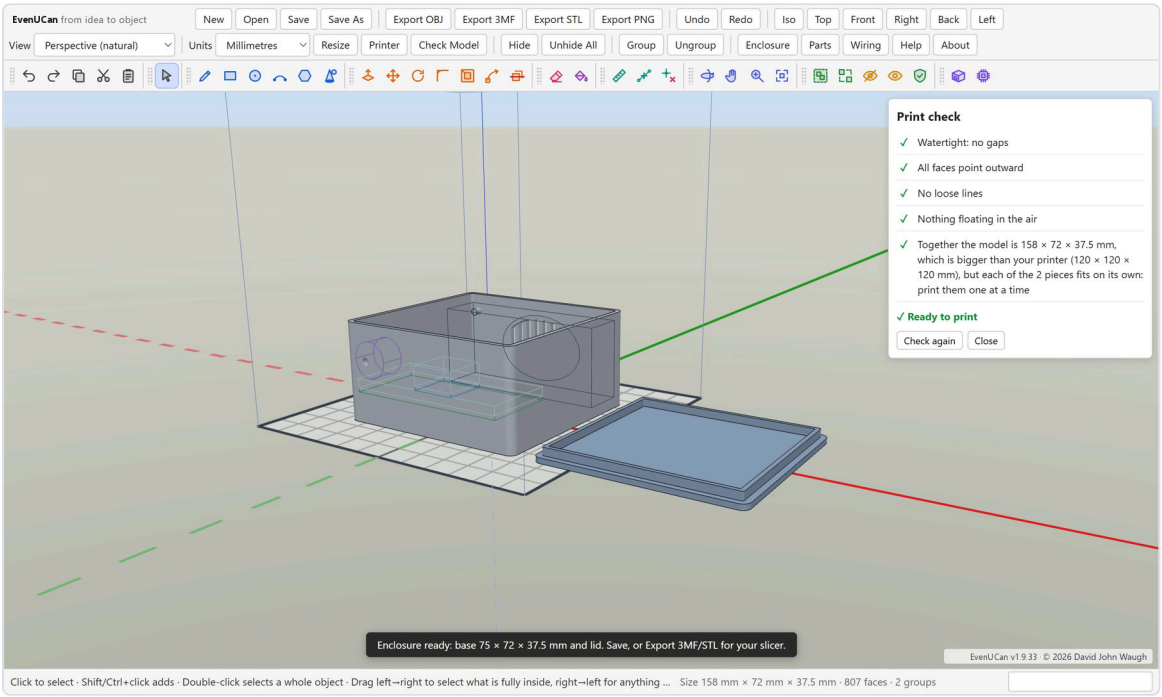
Turn a solid box into a tray or a case: choose **Shell**, type the wall thickness and press `Enter` (it starts at 2 mm), then click the face to leave open, e.g. the top.

- `Shift`+click to pick more faces to leave open first, then click the last one.
- `Ctrl`+click hollows it with no opening (a sealed hollow inside, which slicers print as an empty space).
- It works on box-like shapes: boxes, cylinders, prisms. For a shape with dents or steps, Offset a face inwards and push the middle in instead.



A 60 × 40 × 30 mm box shelled with 2 mm walls and the top left open.

6 Making it ready to print



Check Model: every line ticked means the model is ready to print.

Click **Check Model** (the shield icon). It checks five things and marks any problem right on the model:

Check	If there's a problem
Watertight	Gaps are shown with **thick red lines**. Click **Fill holes**, or trace the gap closed with the Line tool.
Faces point outward	Inside-out faces get **orange outlines**. Click **Fix directions**.

No loose lines	Lines that aren't part of a face won't print. Click **Delete loose lines**.
Nothing floating	A piece hanging in mid-air (not on the bed and not resting on another piece) fails the check, because a printer can't start a part on nothing. It says how far up it is: **Move down to rest** drops it onto what's below, and **Show it** selects it and zooms in.
Fits your printer	Use **Resize** to set the exact size, or **Printer** to change the bed size. Separate groups (such as a base and lid) are checked one at a time: the check gives the whole size and says each piece fits on its own.

Zoom to problems takes you straight to anything that needs fixing. The check also opens by itself if a Save or Export finds a problem.

Sending it to your slicer

Click **Export 3MF** or **Export STL**, then open the file in Cura, PrusaSlicer, Bambu Studio, OrcaSlicer or any other slicer. Sizes are always in millimetres. If something is selected, only the selection is exported. In a 3MF file each separate piece becomes its own part, so the slicer can place them separately.

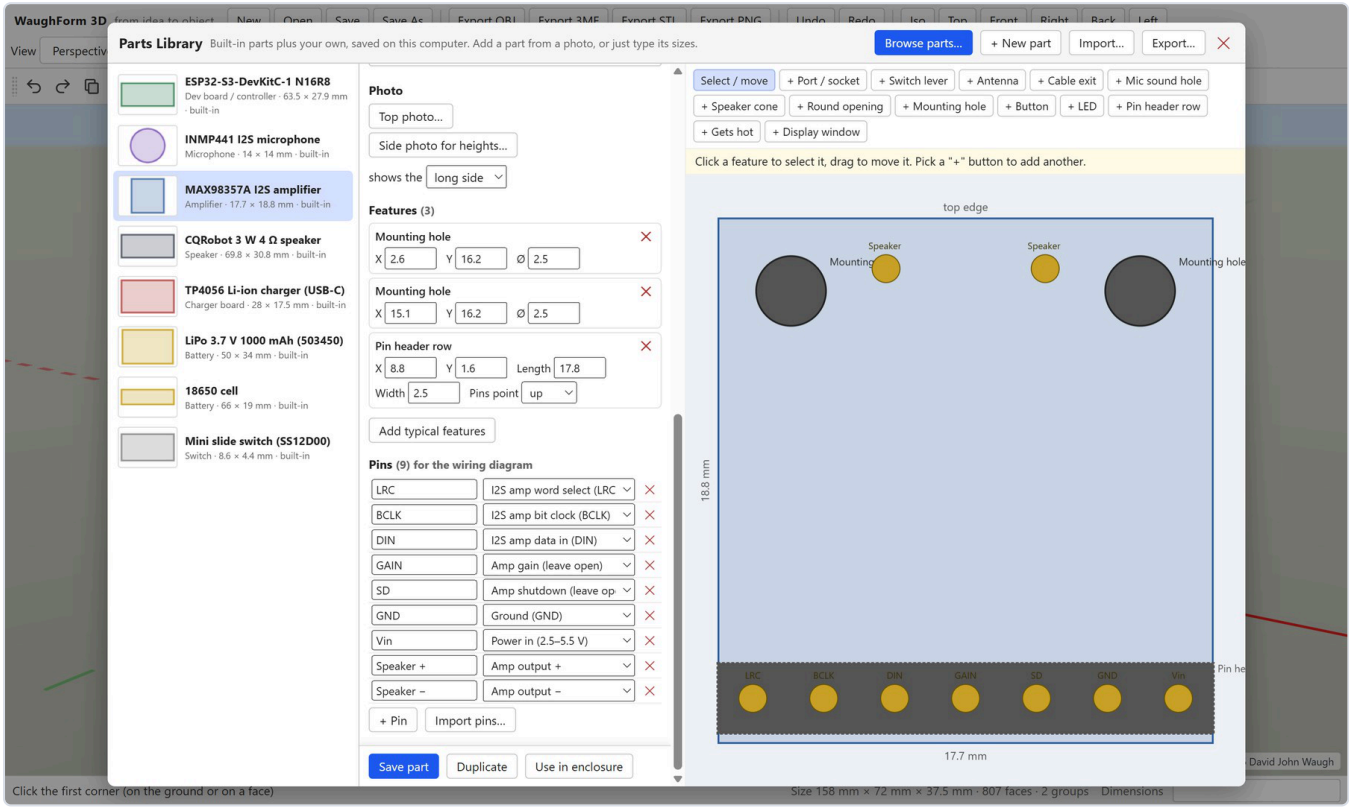
> **Tip:** if a part arrives in the slicer far too big or small, it was drawn with the wrong **Units** setting. Use **Resize** to set its real size.

7 Saving and opening

- **Save** (`Ctrl` + `S`) makes a `.3mf` file. Any slicer can print it, and it opens again in EvenUCan fully editable.
- **Open** (`Ctrl` + `O`) opens `.3mf` and `.stl` files, including ones from other programs: flat areas become editable faces.
- Your work is also **saved automatically** as you go and comes back the next time you open the program.
- **Export PNG** saves a picture of the view; **Export OBJ** is for other 3D programs.

8 The Parts Library

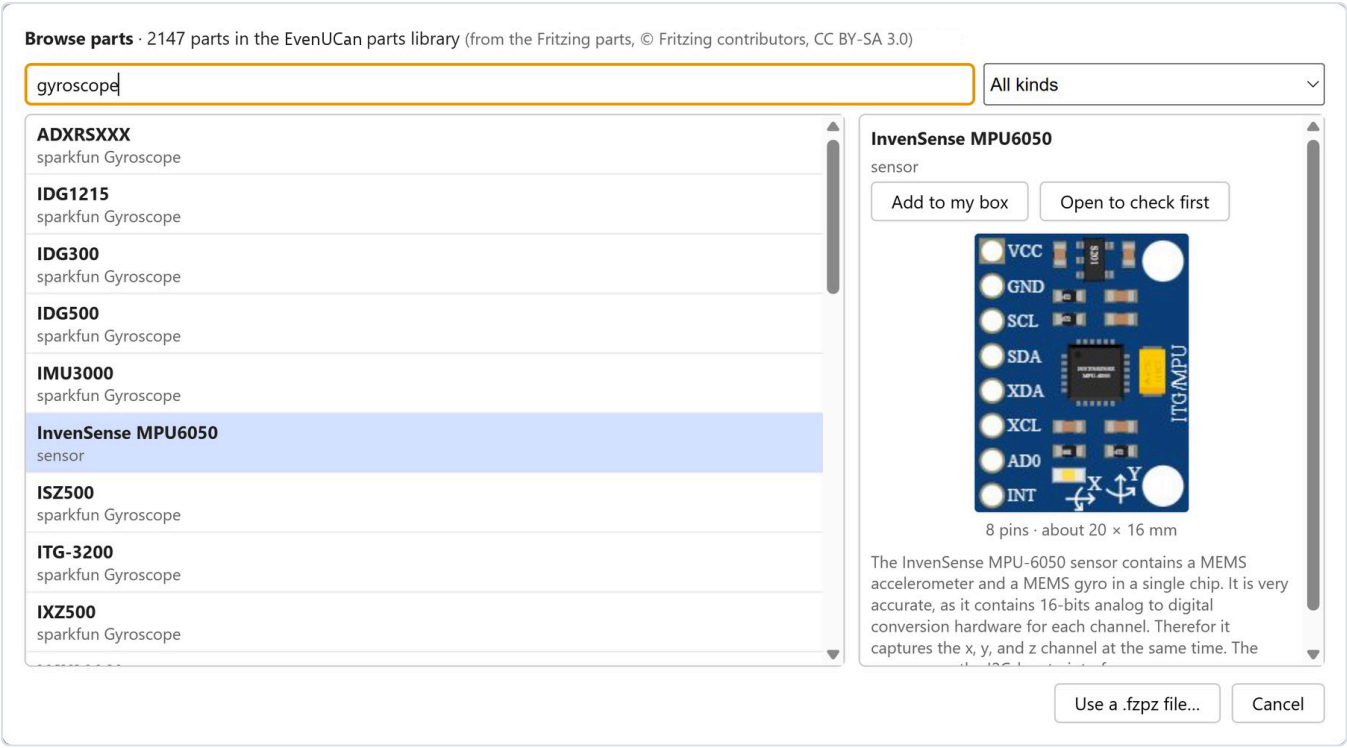
Click **Parts**. The library holds the electronic parts you put in boxes: their size, the holes and sockets that matter, and their pins. It comes with an ESP32-S3 board, an INMP441 microphone, a MAX98357A amplifier, a 3 W speaker, a TP4056 charger, two batteries and a slide switch. Your own parts are saved on your computer.



A part in the library: its sizes and features on the left, the pins table below them, and the picture on the right with features (dark circles) and pins (gold dots).

Browsing ready-made parts

The quickest way to add a part: click **Browse parts...** at the top of the Parts Library (or **Browse over 2,000 ready-made parts** in the Enclosure Wizard). Over 2,000 parts come with EvenUCan, with their pins, sizes and pictures, so no internet or Fritzing is needed.



Browse parts: searching for "gyroscope" finds gyroscope modules even when their names don't say so.

- **Search** by part number (*HC-SR04*, *MPU6050*) or simply by what it does: *gyroscope*, *temperature humidity*, *air quality*, *screen*, *relay*, *GPS*… The best matches come first.
- **All kinds** narrows the list to sensors, boards, displays, motors, sound, power and so on, to scroll through.
- Click a part to see its picture, size, number of pins and description.
- In the web-page version (EvenUCan.html in a browser), the first **Browse parts…** asks for the file `parts-library.json` that comes with it. The browser keeps it, so it only asks once.
- **Add to my box** saves the part and puts it straight into the Enclosure Wizard. **Open to check first** opens it as a new part to look over (and measure against the real board) before you save it.

Adding a part from a photo

1. Measure the part with a ruler or calipers: length, width and height, in millimetres.
2. Take a photo looking **straight down** on it, with a plain background.
3. Click **+ New part**, type a name and the measurements.
4. Click **Top photo…**, choose the picture and click the board's **four corners** in order: top-left, top-right, bottom-right, bottom-left. If a corner is rounded, click where it would be if it were square. The photo is straightened to scale; if it was taken the other way round, it's turned to match, and **Turn photo 180°** fixes upside-down.
5. Mark the important bits: click a **+** button above the picture, then click (or drag) on the photo.
6. Click **Save part**.

Feature	What the box gets
Port / socket	A hole in the wall so you can plug a cable in (USB-C, Micro-USB, DC barrel, jack…). The part is placed with that edge against a wall.

Mounting hole	A post with a screw hole (or a locating peg for parts on a wall). Choose its **Fitting**: a screw post with a pilot hole (the default), or a **push-fit peg** - the board drops straight onto a solid peg through its own hole, with the tip poking a couple of mm proud so it can be melted flat afterwards to rivet the board down for good.
Mic sound hole	A small hole so the microphone can hear outside.
Speaker cone	Slots (a grille) so the sound gets out.
Round opening	A round hole the part shows through: ultrasonic sensor "eyes", IR sensors, buzzers, camera lenses.
Button, LED, Display window	Holes in the lid to press, see or show through.
Antenna	Other parts are kept 10 mm clear of it, so Wi-Fi works well.
Pin header row	Kept clear of the supports; the Prototype style adds room for jumper plugs.
Gets hot	Vent slots in the lid above it.
Switch lever, Cable exit	A slot in the wall for a switch lever, or a notch for a cable.

Usually mounted says whether the part lies flat on the floor or faces out through a wall (microphones, speakers, ultrasonic sensors). For wall parts, photograph the side that faces out. **Side photo for heights...** measures heights from a side-on photo: follow the steps in the yellow bar.

Turn part 90° (under the sizes) turns the whole part a quarter turn clockwise: its sizes, picture, features and pins move together. Use it if a part came in standing up; the long side should run left to right.

Save part, **Duplicate**, **Delete** and **Use in enclosure** stay pinned at the bottom of the details however far you scroll.

Pins and ready-made part files

The **Pins** table at the bottom lists each pin and its role (power, ground, I2S clock, trigger, any signal...). The Wiring window works from these roles. Click **+ Pin** to add one by hand.

Quicker: someone may already have made a **part file** (`.fzpz`) for your board, with all its pins, its size and a picture.

1. In the blue **Fill in automatically** box click **Search for a part file (.fzpz)...**. Your web browser searches for the part name plus "fzpz".
2. Download a `.fzpz` that matches your board.
3. **Drag the file onto the part picture** (or click **Import pins...** › **Use a .fzpz file...**). **Import pins...** also lists the same ready-made parts to search (sensors, boards, modules, displays...), from the parts library that comes with EvenUCan, so you don't need Fritzing or the internet. If Fritzing is installed, its own parts are listed instead.

A board drawn standing up is turned automatically so its long side runs left to right. Always check the pin roles, and measure the board: those pictures keep the pin spacing exact but are sometimes drawn smaller than the real board.

9 Filling in a part automatically

Like the wizard's AI helper, it uses the internet, and only when you click it. AI looks the part up and fills in a **draft**, which you check before saving.

Choosing the AI and adding a key

Both options need a "key" (a password for the AI service), which is kept on your computer only. Choose the AI in the blue **Fill in automatically** box at the top of a part.

AI	Cost	Getting a key
Google Gemini	Free for everyday use; sometimes busy.	Click **Set up free AI key...**, then OK. In Google AI Studio sign in, click **Create API key**, copy it, and paste it into the app.
Claude	Paid per use from credit you add (roughly US$0.10–0.40 a look-up, an estimate). Usually more reliable.	At `console.anthropic.com` sign in, add credit under Billing, then *Settings › API Keys › Create Key*. Paste it with **Set up Claude key...**.

Look up online

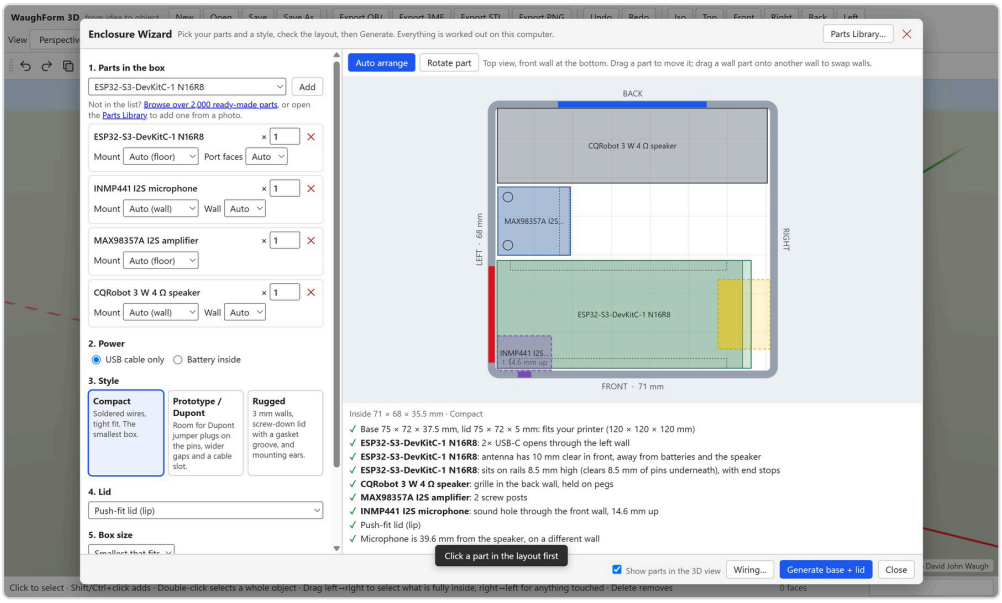
1. Click **+ New part**, then **Look up online...** and type the exact part number (e.g. *HY-SRF05* or *ESP32-S3-DevKitC-1*).
2. The AI searches the web, reads the maker's documentation and fills in the sizes, holes, sockets and pins (if a pinout is shown; pins can also come from a part file, chapter 8). The yellow bar lists anything it wasn't sure of, with links to its sources.
3. In the desktop app it also downloads **product photos** (click one, then its 4 corners, to line it up) and reads any **dimension drawing** or datasheet it found for exact positions. The drawing appears in the top-right corner for checking (hidden while you're lining up a photo, since it would sit right where you need to click); click its ✕ to dismiss it.
4. Check every number, fix anything wrong, and click **Save part**.

If the look-up can't find the part, use **Search images myself...** to find a dimension drawing in Google Images, copy it, and press `Ctrl`+`V` in the part (or use **Read a drawing...**, which also takes a PDF). The AI reads the drawing the same way - sizes, holes, sockets and any pinout shown. Give it a real photo (not a PDF) rather than a drawing and, once it's read the sizes, it offers to use that same photo as the part's picture too: say yes and click its 4 corners to line it up, the same step as **Top photo...**.

> **Always check:** AI can misread drawings, and cheap modules come in several versions with different hole positions. Only the part number (or the drawing and part name) is sent to the AI; on Google's free plan Google may use it to improve its products.

10 The Enclosure Wizard

Click **Enclosure**. Tell it which parts go in the box, and it designs the smallest printable box (base and lid) that fits them, with all the right holes.



The Enclosure Wizard: your choices on the left, the top view of the layout on the right (front wall at the bottom), and what the box does underneath.

1. **Parts:** add them from the list; set how many, and (if you like) which wall a part faces. Remove a part with its red ✕.
2. **Power:** USB cable only, or a battery inside (a battery, charger and on/off switch are added for you).
3. **Style** and **Lid** (see below), and the **Box size**: the smallest that fits, at least a size, or an exact size.
4. Check the **layout**. Drag a part to move it, or drag a wall part onto another wall; **Rotate part** (or `R`) turns the selected part. The list underneath shows ✓ for what's fine and ! or ✗ for what isn't. **Auto arrange** starts again.
5. Click **Generate base + lid**. The base and lid appear as two groups, checked and ready to print.

> **Ports on more than one edge:** a board with sockets on two sides next to each other (USB and power on one edge, another connector on the edge beside it) gets placed in a corner of the box, so both edges sit flush against their own wall. Sockets on two *opposite* edges can't both do that - only one side of a board can touch a given wall - so one sits flush and the other still gets its own hole cut wherever it ends up, with a ! warning giving the gap so you can check a cable actually reaches before printing.

Style	Best for
Compact	Wires soldered in place. The smallest, neatest box.
Prototype / Dupont	Still experimenting: room for push-on jumper wires, wider gaps and a cable slot.
Rugged	Thick 5 mm walls, a screw-down lid with a 3 mm gasket groove (a common O-ring/gasket cord size), mounting ears, and screw posts raised to 6 mm so there's real depth for a screw or a heat-set brass insert.

Lids: **push-fit** (a lip that slides in), **snap-fit** (clicks on), or **screws** (4 × M3 self-tapping into corner posts). Base and lid are separate pieces, so print the lid first to check the fit.

The rules it follows: sockets go against a wall so the hole lines up; microphones face out, away from the speaker; antennas stay clear; chargers sit near batteries; nothing touches anything else.

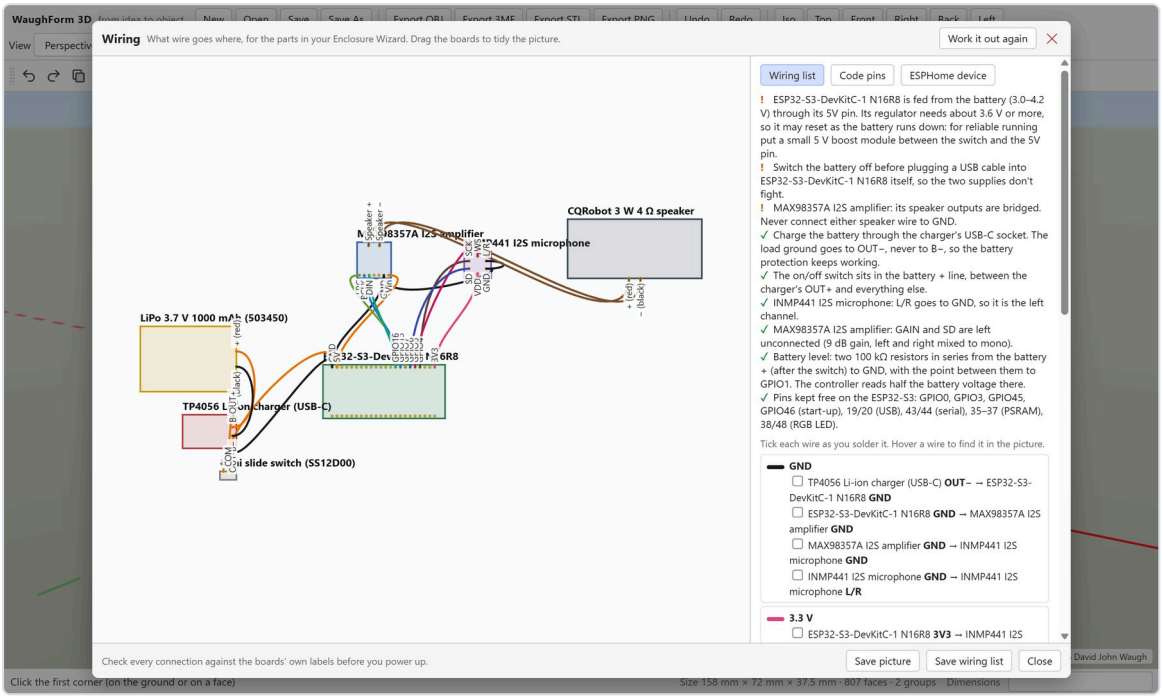
No supports needed: wall parts (e.g. ultrasonic sensors) sit on standoffs with **45° braces**, and press-in rings get a 45° chamfer, so set supports to **None** in your slicer.

Plugs and rivets: for a Rugged box, Generate also prints a small accessory for every hole it finds, each its own separate piece, laid out in a grid in front of the base. A **plug** for each round wall hole/cable-gland (its shaft matches the hole, with a cap about 2 mm wider so it seats flush and can't push through), and a **push-fit rivet** for each screw-post hole still set to "Screw post" (a barbed shaft for the pilot hole, with a flat head to bear on the board - a simple alternative to a screw). Export as **3MF**, not STL, to keep them as separate objects you can select, move or delete on their own in your slicer - STL has no concept of separate objects at all. Both print flange-down (the wide cap/head on the bed) so neither needs supports, and taper down into the shaft over a short cone rather than an abrupt step, so there's no sudden weak point partway up. Like every clearance in this app, the fit is a starting point: tune it to your printer.

TPU gasket: tick "Also print a TPU gasket for the groove" (shown once you pick Rugged, which is the only style with a groove) and Generate adds one more piece - a ring that sits flat on the bed, sized a touch narrower than the groove for an easy push-fit and shallower than its depth so the lid still pulls down snug. It's listed in its own line in the ready message as a reminder to switch to a flexible filament (TPU or similar) before slicing that one piece.

11 Wiring

Click **Wiring** (or **Wiring…** in the Enclosure Wizard). For the parts in your box it works out what wire goes where, using each part's pins.



The Wiring window for an ESP32-S3 with a microphone, amplifier, speaker, battery, charger and switch.

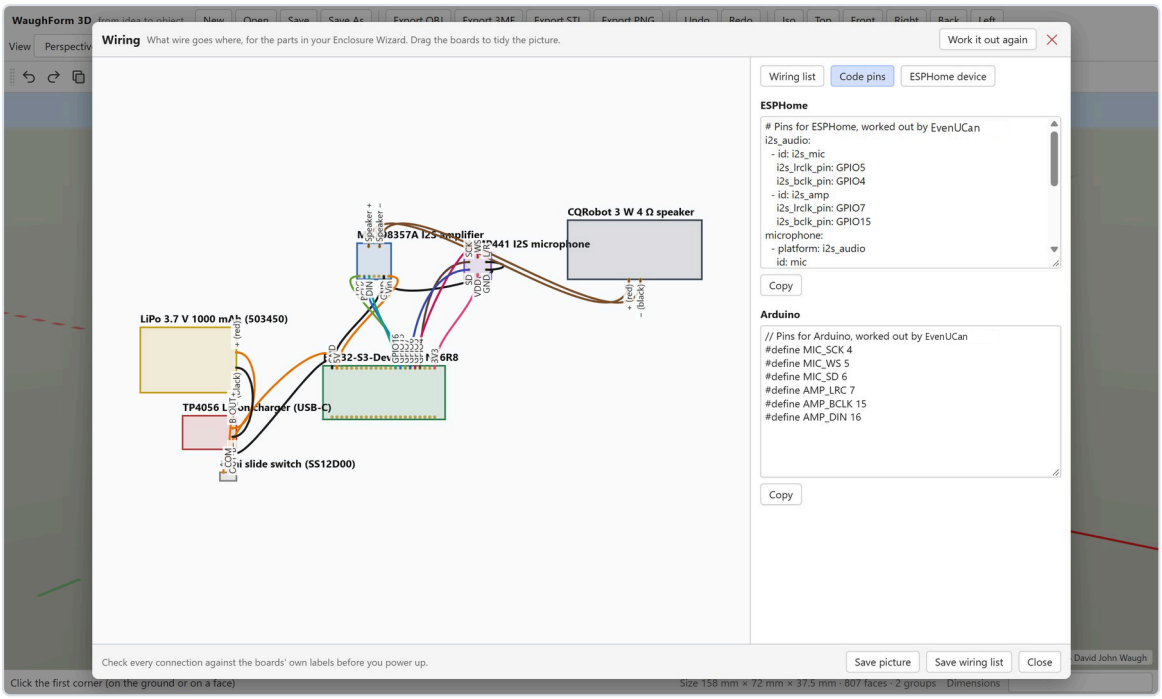
- **Safe pins:** on the ESP32-S3 it never uses the pins that would stop it working: GPIO 0, 3, 45, 46 (start-up), 19/20 (USB), 43/44 (serial), 35–37 (memory on N16R8 boards) and 38/48 (RGB LED).
- **Power:** USB, or battery → charger → switch → everything else, with every ground joined (to the charger's OUT−, never B−).
- **Warnings** for anything risky, such as a 5 V signal into a 3.3 V pin (it tells you which resistors to add) or a speaker wire to ground.

The diagram

Each board with its pins and coloured wires: red 5 V, orange battery, pink 3.3 V, black GND, other colours for signals. Drag boards to tidy it. Hover a wire in the list to find it in the picture. **Save picture** saves it as a PNG.

The wiring list and code

Tick each wire as you solder it; **Save wiring list** saves it to print. **Code pins** gives the matching pin settings for ESPHome and Arduino, ready to copy.



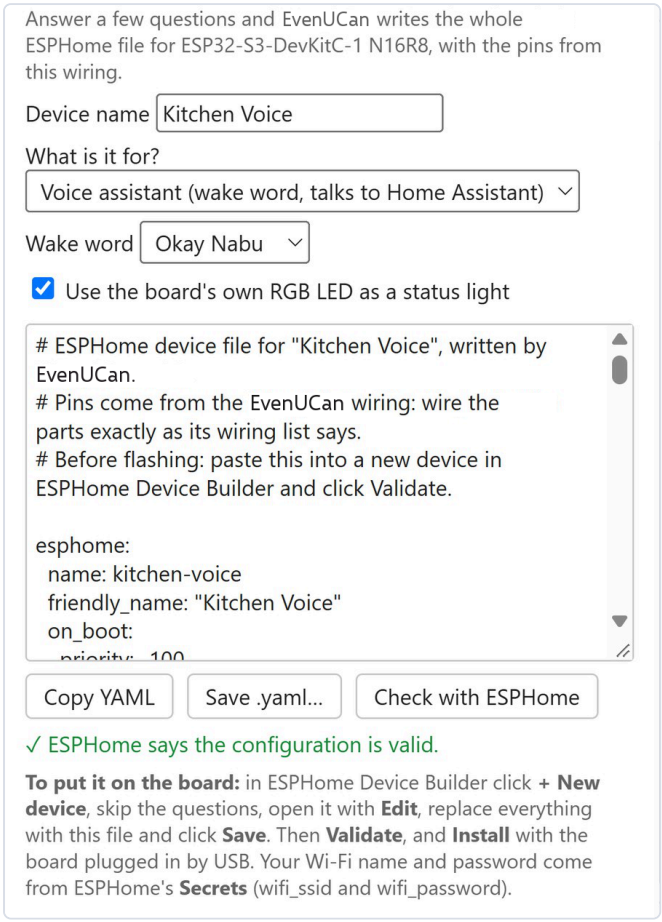
Code pins: the same pins, ready for ESPHome or Arduino.

Arduino or Raspberry Pi: if the controller is one of these instead of an ESP32, the tab next to "Code pins" is named for what it actually writes - "Arduino sketch (.ino)" or "Python program (.py)" - and offers a download link for the software you'll need to use it (the Arduino IDE; or VS Code, for copying a Python file onto a Pi and running it there over Remote-SSH) if it isn't found on this computer. In the desktop program that's a real check; a web page can't see what's installed on your computer at all, so there the link is just always offered.

Before you power up: check every connection against the labels printed on your own boards.

12 Programming your board (ESPHome)

If the controller is an ESP32 (or ESP8266) board, the **ESPHome device** tab in the Wiring window writes the whole file ESPHome needs to program it, using the pins from this wiring, so the board and the wires always match.

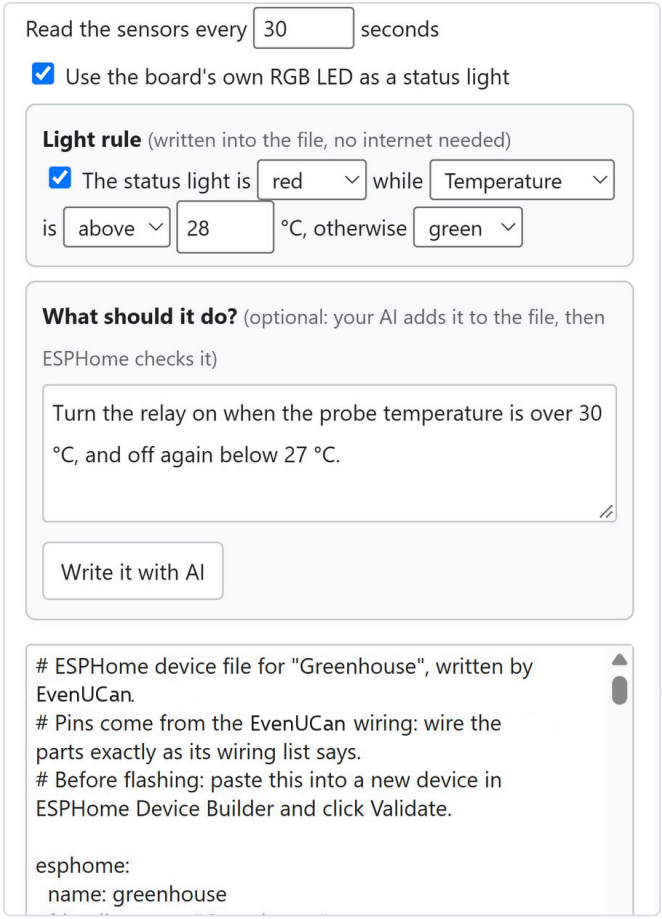


The ESPHome device tab for a voice assistant, checked with ESPHome.

1. Open Wiring and click the **ESPHome device** tab.
2. Give the device a **name** (it's how Home Assistant shows it) and choose what it's for:
   - **Sensor node**: reports its readings (distance, temperature, motion, button, battery…). Works with **Home Assistant**, or **on its own** with its own web page. Set how often it reads, and the "Something close" alarm distance for an ultrasonic sensor.
   - **Voice assistant**: needs an I2S microphone and amplifier with a speaker. Pick the wake word; it talks to Home Assistant.
3. Answer the other questions shown: battery-low level, what the button does, and whether the board's own RGB LED is a status light.
4. Click **Open in ESPHome**. The device goes straight into ESPHome Device Builder on this computer, and ESPHome opens. (If a device of that name is already there, it asks before replacing it.) **Check with ESPHome** checks the file first, the same as Validate; **Copy YAML** and **Save .yaml…** are there if you want the file itself.
5. In ESPHome, find your device, plug the board in by USB and click **Install**. ESPHome builds the program and puts it on the board. Your Wi-Fi name and password come from ESPHome's **Secrets**; EvenUCan tells you if they're missing.

Your Wi-Fi name and password are not in the file: it uses ESPHome's **Secrets** (`wifi_ssid`, `wifi_password`). Parts it knows get their own section (I2S microphone and amplifier, ultrasonic sensors, DHT11/DHT22 and DS18B20 temperature sensors, BME280, BMP280, AHT10/20 and SHT3x sensors, buttons, PIR motion sensors, LEDs, relays, buzzers, battery level) straight away. **Any other part, such as one you imported from a part file, is handled by your AI:** the tab lists it under "needs the AI", and one click on **Make it with AI** writes its code from the part's name, its part-file description and its pins. You don't need to know what the module is or how it works.

Telling it what to do



A light rule, and a description for the AI.

Light rule (no internet needed): tick it and fill in the sentence, for example *The status light is **red** while **Temperature** is **above 28 °C**, otherwise **green***. It works with any reading the device has (temperature, humidity, distance, battery voltage…) and the board's RGB status light, or a plain LED (on/off).

What should it do? (uses your AI key): optional. If you leave it empty, **Make it with AI** just makes every part work and report its readings. Or describe it in your own words, for example "*Turn the relay on when the probe is over 30 °C and off again below 27 °C*", and click **Make it with AI**. Your AI (Gemini or Claude, set up in Parts) adds it to the file without touching the pins or Wi-Fi. ESPHome on this computer then checks the result; if it finds a mistake, the error goes back to the AI to fix, up to three tries. The panel shows ✓ when it passes, with the AI's own notes on what it added.

Always read an AI-written file through before installing it. **Back to the plain file** undoes it, and changing any answer goes back to the plain file too.

> **Battery level:** with a battery, the wiring adds two 100 kΩ resistors from the battery + (after the switch) to GND, with the middle going to a measuring pin, so the board can report its battery voltage.

13 Sharing with other people

- **Drawings:** send the `.3mf` file you saved. Slicers print it, and EvenUCan opens it fully editable.
- **Parts:** in Parts click **Export...** and send the `.json` file; they click **Import...**. If your parts have photos you can export with or without them. Photos downloaded from websites belong to whoever took them, so choose **Export without photos** when sharing.
- **The program:** send the `.exe` with this manual, the README and the checksums file, or simply send the link to the GitHub download page. Each person sets up their own AI key if they want the online feature; keys are never shared.

14 Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Does
`Space`	Select
`L`	Line
`R`	Rectangle
`C`	Circle
`A`	Arc
`N`	Polygon
`D`	3D Shapes
`P`	Push/Pull
`M`	Move / Copy (hold `Ctrl`)
`Q`	Rotate
`F`	Offset
`J`	Round / Chamfer
`W`	Follow Me
`X`	Slice
`E`	Eraser
`B`	Paint Bucket
`T`	Tape Measure
`K`	Find Centre
`O` `H` `Z`	Orbit, Pan, Zoom

Key	Does
`Shift` + `Z`	Fit everything in view
`G` / `Shift` + `G`	Group / Ungroup
`U`	Join the selected objects into one solid
`S`	Subtract: cut the other selected objects out of the first one picked
`Shift` + `H` / `Shift` + `U`	Hide / Unhide all
`Shift` + `E`	Delete all guide points
`→` `←` `↑` `↓`	Lock to X, Y, Z / unlock
`Ctrl` + `Z` / `Ctrl` + `Y`	Undo / Redo
`Ctrl` + `S`	Save (`Shift` for Save As)
`Ctrl` + `O` / `Ctrl` + `N`	Open / New
`Ctrl` + `C` / `X` / `V`	Copy / Cut / Paste
`Ctrl` + `A` / `Ctrl` + `T`	Select everything / nothing
`Delete`	Delete the selection
`Esc`	Cancel / close a window
`F1`	Help
Right-click a text box	Cut, Copy, Paste text

15 Problems and answers

Problem	What to do
The part is huge or tiny in the slicer	It was drawn with the wrong Units. Use **Resize** to set its real size in mm.
The slicer says the model isn't closed	Click **Check Model**, then **Fill holes** and **Fix directions**.
Nothing happens when I click to draw	Check which tool is highlighted on the toolbar. The left button always belongs to that tool.
The 3D view looks washed out	Windows HDR can do this. Try turning HDR off in *Windows Settings › Display*.
The Enclosure Wizard can't fit the parts	Try another style, set a part's mount or wall back to Auto, or choose a bigger size.
Look up online fills nothing in	Click **Show AI reply** to see what came back. "Busy" means try again later or switch AI; otherwise try the exact part number, or use Search images myself… and Read a drawing.
Follow Me says "First select the path"	Select the path with `Space` first (it turns blue), then press `W` and click the shape.
A rounding or offset is refused	Read the status bar: usually the size is too big for the face beside it. Type a smaller size and press `Enter`.
A part is missing from the wiring diagram	It has no pins yet. Add them in Parts, or use **Import pins…**.
Which version do I have?	Click **About** (top right), or look in the bottom-right corner of the 3D view. **Copy version** copies it, to paste into a message.
My work disappeared	The last drawing is saved automatically and comes back when you open the program. Keep important work saved as `.3mf` files too.

16 Credits

EvenUCan was created by David John Waugh. © 2026 David John Waugh. It is free software: you can share it and change it under the GNU General Public License, version 3 or any later version. It comes with no warranty.

- The Enclosure Wizard's solid modelling uses the **Manifold** geometry library (© The Manifold Authors, Apache License 2.0), built into the program.
- The optional Claude look-up uses the **Anthropic TypeScript SDK** (© Anthropic, Apache License 2.0), also built in.
- Parts brought in with **Import pins…** from a `.fzpz` file or the Fritzing parts library keep their credit (© Fritzing contributors, CC BY-SA 3.0) in the part's notes. The parts library that comes with EvenUCan (over 2,000 parts, with their pins and pictures) is made from the Fritzing parts library, © Fritzing contributors, licensed under **CC BY-SA 3.0** (creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0); parts made from it keep that credit and licence.
- ESP32-S3-DevKitC-1 pin layout from Espressif's ESP32-S3-DevKitC-1 user guide.